

DETAILS FOR BOI CHATBOT

Bureau of Immigration (BoI): FAQs

Q: When was the Bureau of Immigration (BoI) established?

A: The BoI was established in 1971.

Q: What are the primary functions of the Bureau of Immigration?

A: The BoI is the primary authority in India responsible for enforcing rules regarding the entry, stay, and exit of foreign nationals. It acts as the authentic gateway for travel regulations and immigration services.

Q: Who leads the Bureau of Immigration?

A: The BoI is headed by the Commissioner of Immigration.

Q: Contact details of Commissioner, Bureau of Immigration

A: Name: Ms. I.B. Rani, IPS

Office Address: 7th Floor, Tower 'J', World Trade Centre (WTC), Nauroji Nagar, New Delhi - 110029

Telephone No: 011-26102622 (Telefax)

Q: Where does the BoI manage immigration facilities?

A: The BoI manages immigration services across India's International Check Posts (ICPs) through FRROs (Foreigners Regional Registration Offices) and CHIOs (Chief Immigration Officers).

Q: What are the Services provided by the BoI for foreign nationals living in India?

A: The BoI oversees registration services and visa-related formalities for foreign nationals residing in India, ensuring all activities comply with the relevant Acts, Rules, and Regulations.

Q: How many Immigration Check Posts (ICPs) are currently operational in India?

A: There is a total of **114 Immigration Check Posts** across India, covering air, sea, land, rail, and river routes to manage international traffic.

Q: How many Foreigners Regional Registration Offices (FRROs) are there under BoI? Where are they located?

A: **There are 15 FRROs.** They are located in Ahmedabad, Amritsar, Bangalore, Calicut, Chandigarh, Chennai, Cochin, Delhi, Guwahati, Hyderabad, Jaipur, Kolkata, Lucknow, Mumbai, and Trivandrum.

Q: How many Chief Immigration Officers are there? Where are they stationed?

A: **There are 24 Chief Immigration Officers** functioning at Goa, Jaipur, Gaya, Varanasi, Nagpur, Pune, Indore, Mangalore, Trichy, Coimbatore, Bagdogra, Chandigarh, Haridaspur, Kannur, Dera Baba Nanak, Raxaul, Sonauli, Gede, Munabao, Chitpur, Guwahati, New Jalpaiguri, Dhamra, and Mopa.

Q: Who handles foreigner registration in areas where there is no FRRO or Chief Immigration Officer?

A: In locations, where there is no FRRO or Chief Immigration Officer, the District Superintendents of Police (SPs) act as the Foreigners Registration Officers (FROs).

HEALTH REGULATIONS: YELLOW FEVER

Q: "Who requires a Yellow Fever vaccination to enter India?"

Q: You only need a valid Yellow Fever Vaccination Certificate if you are arriving from or have transited through a Yellow Fever endemic country by air or sea.

Q: What happens if I arrive from an endemic area without a certificate?

A: If you have visited or transited through an endemic area and cannot produce a valid certificate, you will be placed in quarantine for up to 6 days.

This rule applies to everyone except infants under six months old.

Q: I am leaving India for an endemic country. Is a vaccine required?

A: There is no mandatory health check required by the Indian government for departure. However, it is strongly advised to get vaccinated and carry a certificate for your own safety and to meet the entry requirements of your destination country.

Q: How do I get an Indian visa if I am in a Yellow Fever endemic country?

A: Indian Missions typically require you to show a valid vaccination certificate before issuing a visa. Once verified, they will mark your visa with the endorsement: "Valid Yellow Fever Vaccination Certificate Checked."

Q: Which countries are considered Yellow Fever endemic?

A: There are currently 43 notified countries. Please see the list below:

Africa (30 Countries)

Angola, Benin, Burkina Faso, Burundi, Cameroon, Central African Republic, Chad, Congo, Cote d' Ivoire, Democratic Republic of Congo, Equatorial Guinea, Ethiopia, Gabon, Gambia, Ghana, Guinea, Guinea Bissau, Kenya, Liberia, Mali, Mauritania, Niger, Nigeria, Rwanda, Senegal, Sierra Leone, Sudan, South Sudan, Togo, Uganda.

South America (13 Countries)

Argentina, Bolivia, Brazil, Colombia, Ecuador, French Guyana, Guyana, Suriname, Trinidad (Trinidad only), Venezuela, Panama, Paraguay, Peru.

Q: Where can I find more details on health requirements?

A: For the most up-to-date information, you can visit the official International Health Port Health Organization (IHPHO) website at: ihpoe.mohfw.gov.in.

IDENTITY INFORMATION

Q: Do I need to provide biometrics when applying for an Indian visa?

A: Yes. Under the 2025 Order, every foreigner applying for any visa category - including OCI (Overseas Citizen of India) registration-must

provide their biometric information to the issuing authority before the visa or registration is granted.

Q: Who can collect my biometrics while I am in India?

A: If you are identified as a foreigner while in India, you may be required to provide biometrics on the Central Government's electronic portal by any of the following authorities:

- Specified State or Union Territory authorities.
- Civil authorities or Registration Officers.
- Immigration Officers.
- Border Guarding Forces or the Coast Guard.

Q: How long is my captured biometric information valid?

A: Your biometric data remains valid for 10 years from the date it was captured.

Q: What if I have poor fingerprints or missing fingers?

A: The regulations provide the following exemptions:

- **Poor/No Fingerprints: You are exempt from fingerprinting; however, your facial traits or iris scan will be captured instead.**
- **Missing Fingers:** If you have fewer than ten fingers, you are only required to provide fingerprints for your existing fingers.

Q: Where can I find the technical specifications for these biometrics?

A: Biometrics are captured according to specifications set by the Central Government, which may be updated periodically. For the most current technical details, please visit the **Ministry of Home Affairs** website at www.mha.gov.in.

OBLIGATION OF CARRIERS:

Q: What information must airlines provide for international flights?

A: Airline station managers must provide:

- Passenger and Crew Manifest (Form V).
- Advance Passenger Information (API): Data including Name, Gender, DOB, Nationality, Passport/Visa details, and Flight info.
- Passenger Name Record (PNR): Comprehensive travel and payment data.

Q: When should Advance Passenger Information (API) be submitted?

A:

- **Arrivals to India:** Within 15 minutes of "wheels-off" from the port of embarkation outside India.
- **Departures from India:** Immediately after boarding is closed or "wheels-off" within India.
- Format required: UNEDIFACT-PAXLST.

Q: What is the timeline for submitting PNR data?

A: PNR data must be submitted at four specific intervals:

1. T-72 hours
2. T-24 hours
3. T-08 hours
4. T-0 hours (*Where T is the scheduled time of arrival in or departure from India*).

Q: What are the requirements for cargo, cruise, or chartered ships?

A: The vessel's master or representative must submit the Passenger and Crew Manifest (Form VI).

Q: What is the deadline for vessel manifest submission?

A: Information must be provided at T-72 hours (72 hours before scheduled arrival in or departure from India).

Q: What is the "General Declaration" requirement?

A: Every carrier (Air, Sea, or Road) must submit a General Declaration in Form VIII to the Immigration Officer.

Q: When must the General Declaration be submitted?

A: It must be submitted at D-45 minutes (45 minutes before the scheduled departure time).

Q: Can a flight or vessel depart before clearance?

A: No. No transport mode is permitted to depart until the Immigration Officer has provided official clearance on the General Declaration.

Q: Who do I contact for technical or administrative help? With regard to APIS?

A:

- Technical (APIS implementation): apisindia@nic.in
- Administrative matters: frrodli@nic.in

Q: Where can I find official guidelines regarding APIS?

A: You can download the following documents from the official portal:

1. [Immigration and Foreigners Rules, 2025](#) (967 KB)
2. [APIS Guidelines to the Carriers](#) (155 KB)
3. [FAQs](#) (181 KB)
4. [Time Limit for compliance with APIS](#) (11KB)
5. [Stabilization of APIS Data](#) (11 kB)

INDIAN CITIZENSHIP

Acquisition of Indian citizenship:

Please visit <https://indiancitizenshiponline.nic.in/>

Q: Does India allow dual citizenship?

A: No. The **Indian Citizenship Act** does not provide for dual citizenship. Once you acquire the nationality of another country, you must renounce your Indian citizenship.

Q: What is my first obligation after acquiring foreign nationality?

A: Under the **Passports Act**, it is mandatory to surrender your last Indian passport to the nearest Indian Consulate or Regional Passport Office (RPO) immediately after becoming a foreign citizen.

Q: Is it illegal to keep an Indian passport after becoming a foreign national?

A: Yes. It is an **offence** under both the **Citizenship Act** and the **Passports Act** for a foreign national to hold an Indian passport.

Q. What documents will I receive after surrendering my passport?

A: The Consulate or RPO will cancel your Indian passport and return it to you along with a **Renunciation/Surrender Certificate**.

Q: Where can I apply for a Renunciation Certificate?

A: If you acquired foreign nationality **after June 1, 2010**, you must apply for the Renunciation Certificate online through the Ministry of Home Affairs website:

<https://indiancitizenshiponline.nic.in/Renounce>

Q: What should I do with my Indian Voter ID or EPIC Card?

A: Upon surrendering your Indian passport, you are also required to surrender your Indian Voter ID Card (EPIC Card).

Q: How do I handle my Indian Ration Card after renouncing citizenship?

A: You must contact the local authority concerned to ensure your records are **removed** from the Ration Card system.

Q: Where can I find more technical information on the surrender process?

A: For detailed instructions and procedural information, you can visit the official passport portal at: www.passportindia.gov.in

LIST OF ICPs

Q: Which FRRO oversees my airport?

A:

- The controlling authority for the Immigration Check Post (ICP) at Ahmedabad (Gujarat) is FRRO Ahmedabad.
- The controlling authority for the Immigration Check Post (ICP) at Lucknow (Uttar Pradesh) is FRRO Lucknow.
- The controlling authority for the Immigration Check Post (ICP) at Amritsar (Punjab) is FRRO Amritsar.
- The controlling authority for the Immigration Check Post (ICP) at Varanasi (Uttar Pradesh) is FRRO Lucknow.
- The controlling authority for the Immigration Check Post (ICP) at Bagdogra (West Bengal) is FRRO Kolkata.
- The controlling authority for the Immigration Check Post (ICP) at Bangalore (Karnataka) is FRRO Bangalore.
- The controlling authority for the Immigration Check Post (ICP) at Calicut (Kerala) is FRRO Calicut.
- The controlling authority for the Immigration Check Post (ICP) at Chandigarh (Haryana) is FRRO Amritsar.
- The controlling authority for the Immigration Check Post (ICP) at Chennai (Tamil Nadu) is FRRO Chennai.
- The controlling authority for the Immigration Check Post (ICP) at Cochin (Kerala) is FRRO Cochin.
- The controlling authority for the Immigration Check Post (ICP) at Coimbatore (Tamil Nadu) is FRRO Chennai.
- The controlling authority for the Immigration Check Post (ICP) at Dabolim (Goa) is FRRO Mumbai.
- The controlling authority for the Immigration Check Post (ICP) at Delhi (National Capital Territory of Delhi) is FRRO Delhi.
- The controlling authority for the Immigration Check Post (ICP) at Gaya (Bihar) is FRRO Kolkata.
- The controlling authority for the Immigration Check Post (ICP) at Guwahati (Assam) is FRRO Kolkata.
- The controlling authority for the Immigration Check Post (ICP) at Hyderabad (Telangana) is FRRO Hyderabad.
- The controlling authority for the Immigration Check Post (ICP) at Indore (Madhya Pradesh) is FRRO Mumbai.
- The controlling authority for the Immigration Check Post (ICP) at Jaipur (Rajasthan) is FRRO Delhi.
- The controlling authority for the Immigration Check Post (ICP) at Kolkata (West Bengal) is FRRO Kolkata.

- The controlling authority for the Immigration Check Post (ICP) at Kannur (Kerala) is FRRO Calicut.
- The controlling authority for the Immigration Check Post (ICP) at Mangalore (Karnataka) is FRRO Bangalore.
- The controlling authority for the Immigration Check Post (ICP) at Mumbai (Maharashtra) is FRRO Mumbai.
- The controlling authority for the Immigration Check Post (ICP) at Manohar International Airport, Mopa (Goa) is FRRO Mumbai.
- The controlling authority for the Immigration Check Post (ICP) at Nagpur (Maharashtra) is FRRO Mumbai.
- The controlling authority for the Immigration Check Post (ICP) at Pune (Maharashtra) is FRRO Mumbai.
- The controlling authority for the Immigration Check Post (ICP) at Trichy (Tamil Nadu) is FRRO Chennai.
- The controlling authority for the Immigration Check Post (ICP) at Trivandrum (Kerala) is FRRO Trivandrum.
- The controlling authority for the Immigration Check Post (ICP) at Raja Bhoj International Airport, Bhopal (Madhya Pradesh) is FRRO Mumbai.
- The controlling authority for the Immigration Check Post (ICP) at Bhubaneswar (Odisha) is FRO/SP Bhubaneswar.
- The controlling authority for the Immigration Check Post (ICP) at Madurai (Tamil Nadu) is FRO/SP Madurai.
- The controlling authority for the Immigration Check Post (ICP) at Patna (Bihar) is FRO/SP Patna.
- The controlling authority for the Immigration Check Post (ICP) at Port Blair (Andaman & Nicobar Islands) is FRO/SP Port Blair.
- The controlling authority for the Immigration Check Post (ICP) at Srinagar (Jammu & Kashmir) is FRO/SP Kashmir.
- The controlling authority for the Immigration Check Post (ICP) at Surat (Gujarat) is FRO/SP Surat.
- The controlling authority for the Immigration Check Post (ICP) at Tirupati (Andhra Pradesh) is FRO/SP Tirupati.
- The controlling authority for the Immigration Check Post (ICP) at Visakhapatnam (Andhra Pradesh) is FRO/SP Visakhapatnam.
- The controlling authority for the Immigration Check Post (ICP) at Vijayawada (Andhra Pradesh) is FRO/SP Vijayawada.

Q: What are the major seaports? Who are the jurisdictional FRROs?

A: Jurisdiction is as given below:

- **FRRO Mumbai:** Mumbai, Nhava Sheva (JNPT), and Mormugao (Goa).
- **FRRO Ahmedabad:** Kandla and Mundra.
- **FRRO Bangalore:** New Mangalore.
- **FRRO Hyderabad:** Dhamra (Odisha).
- **FRRO Chennai:** Chennai and Kattupalli.
- **FRRO Trivandrum:** Kovalam-Vizhinjam, Kollam, and Vizhinjam International Seaport.
- **FRRO Cochin:** Cochin Port and Vallarpadam.
- **FRRO Calicut:** Calicut.

Authorities for and several Assam river ports (Karimganj, Pandu, Dhubri, Silghat) are currently pending notification.

Q: What are the land ICPs? Who are the jurisdictional FRROs?

A: Land border ICPs are managed as follows:

- **FRRO Kolkata (Widest Range):** Agartala, Haridaspur, Jaigaon, Gede, Ghojadanga, Moreh (Manipur), and Raxaul (Bihar).
- **FRRO Amritsar:** Attari Road and Dera Baba Nanak (Kartarpur).
- **FRRO Lucknow:** Sonauli and Rupaidiha.

Q: What are the Rail Checkposts? Who are the jurisdictional FRROs?

- The controlling authority for the Immigration Check Post (ICP) at **Attari (Amritsar, Punjab)** is **FRRO Amritsar**.

- The controlling authority for the **Petrapole/Chitpur (West Bengal)** Immigration Check Post (ICP) is **FRRO Kolkata**.
- The controlling authority for the **Gede Rail and Road Check Post (West Bengal)** Immigration Check Post (ICP) is **FRRO Kolkata**.
- The controlling authority for the **Haridaspur (West Bengal)** Immigration Check Post (ICP) is **FRRO Kolkata**.
- The controlling authority for the **Munabao (Rajasthan)** Immigration Check Post (ICP) is **FRRO Delhi**.
- The controlling authority for the **New Jalpaiguri Railway Station (West Bengal)** Immigration Check Post (ICP) is **FRRO Kolkata**.

General Visa Information

Q: What is a Business Visa (B), and who can apply?

A: The Business Visa is for individuals engaging in commercial activities. The sub-categories are:

- **B-1:** For general business activities, including maintenance and repair (MRO) of aircraft or ships.
- **B-2:** For sports persons and coaches on contract with remuneration.
- **B-3:** For cultural or commercial performances (acting, dance, music, etc.).
- **B-4: Production Investment Business Visa** (available only via the e-Visa platform).
- **B-5 (Conference):** For attending international seminars, workshops, or conferences.
- **B-6 (Film):** For shooting feature films, reality TV, web series, or location scouting.

Q: Is there a specific visa for long-term investors?

A: Yes. Investors may apply for **PRS (Permanent Residency Status)**, specifically designed for foreign investors looking for long-term stay options.

Q: What are the categories for Student Visas (S)?

A: Student visas are categorized based on the level and type of study:

- **S-1:** Higher education, exchange programs, and skill development in Ayush or Theological studies.
- **S-2:** School-level education.
- **S-3:** Studies in Yoga, Vedic culture, Indian music/dance, Buddhist studies, or Indian languages.
- **S-4:** Research scholars, visiting faculty, and **G-20 Talent Visa** holders.
- **S-5:** For individuals undertaking an **Internship** in India.

Q: What does a Tourist Visa (T) cover?

A: The Tourist Visa is divided into two types:

- **T-1:** For sightseeing, recreation, visiting friends/relatives, short-term yoga, or casual courses (under 6 months) that do not result in a formal degree.
- **T-2:** Specifically for foreign nationals participating in **mountaineering expeditions**.

Q: Which visa should I apply for if I need medical treatment?

A:

- **M-1:** For general medical treatment (excluding Ayush).
- **M-3:** Specifically for treatment under **Ayush systems** (Ayurveda, Yoga, etc.).
- **M-2 & M-4:** For **Medical Attendants** accompanying patients on M-1 or M-3 visas, respectively.

Q: What is an Employment/Work Visa (E)?

A:

- **E-1:** For general employment, including intra-company transfers.
- **E-2:** For those working with **NGOs**.

- **E-3:** For **Missionaries** or religious workers of approved organizations.

Q: What are the special visas for family members of visa holders?

A:

- **F Visa:** For dependents of most visa categories.
- **D-1X to D-5X:** Specifically for dependents of **Diplomatic** (D) visa holders.
- **O-1X to O-4X:** Specifically for dependents of **Official** (O) visa holders.

Q: What are the "Miscellaneous" (X) Visa categories?

A: These are for specific circumstances:

- **X-1:** For Persons of Indian Origin (PIO) and their foreign spouses/children.
- **X-2:** For those joining approved organizations like **Auroville**, Aurobindo Ashram, or Buddhist Monasteries.
- **X-4:** A specific stay visa for **Afghan Nationals**.
- **X-Misc:** For any legitimate purpose not covered by other categories.

Q: What are the rules for Pakistan, Bangladesh, and Afghanistan nationals?

A: Specific regulations apply:

- **P-1 to P-3:** Specific visas for Pakistan nationals (Visitors or Pilgrims).
- **X-3:** A double-entry visa for Bangladesh nationals applying for third-country visas in India.
- **LTV (Long Term Visa):** Available for certain categories of citizens from Afghanistan, Bangladesh, and Pakistan.

Q: What is a Transit Visa (TR)?

A: The **TR Visa** is solely for the purpose of traveling through India to reach a final destination in another country.

Q: What is a Business (B) Visa used for? A: The Business Visa is primarily for individuals visiting India for trade and commerce. It also covers more specific professional activities, such as sports persons, coaches, and those involved in film production or attending international conferences.

Q: Who should apply for a Diplomatic (D) Visa? A: This category is reserved for diplomats assigned to India and UN officials. It is specifically meant for those traveling on diplomatic passports for official meetings or postings.

Q: What does the Employment (E) Visa cover? A: If you are coming to India for a job or to work with an NGO, you would apply for an Employment Visa. This includes both standard company hires and intra-company transferees.

Q: Can I use a Student (S) Visa for internships? A: Yes, the Student Visa is quite broad. While it is mainly for those attending schools or universities and conducting research, it also specifically includes those coming to India for internships.

Q: What activities are allowed on a Tourist (T) Visa? A: The Tourist Visa is meant for non-business and non-academic visits. It is the correct choice for sightseeing, recreation, or casual visits to meet friends and relatives.

Q: Which visa category should I select for medical treatment? A: You should apply for a Medical (M) Visa. This category covers both the patients seeking treatment—whether in standard hospitals or Ayush systems—and their designated medical attendants.

Q: Is there a specific visa for media professionals? A: Yes, the Journalist (J) Visa is designed for accredited journalists visiting India for professional purposes, as well as those coming to shoot advertisements or documentaries.

Q: How do family members of visa holders stay in India? A: Dependents of most foreign nationals holding a primary visa (like a Work or Student visa) should apply for a Family (F) Visa. However,

please note that dependents of diplomats have their own specific sub-categories under the Diplomatic class.

Q: What is the purpose of an Official (O) Visa? A: The Official Visa is for government officials who are on a visit to India for official duties but do not hold diplomatic status. This typically applies to those traveling on Official, Service, or Special passports.

VISA APPLICATIONS AND EXTENSIONS: Frequently Asked Questions

Q: How do I apply for a regular or e-Visa to visit India?

A: To apply for a visa, you should complete the online application form available at the official government website: <https://indianvisaonline.gov.in>. Please keep in mind that a valid visa along with your passport is mandatory for travel to India, unless you are an OCI cardholder or belong to a category exempted under a specific bilateral agreement.

Q: Are there any authorized agents who can provide express or emergency visa services for a fee?

A: It is important to be cautious of third-party services. The Government of India has not authorized any agents or intermediaries to charge fees for facilitating emergency or express regular visas or e-Visas.

Q: What should I do if I need to extend my stay while I am already in India?

A: If you have a justifiable reason for staying beyond your current visa's validity, you must apply for an extension through the FRRO (Foreigners Regional Registration Office) website at <https://indianfrro.gov.in>. Please note that these services are only available to foreign nationals who are currently present in India.

Q: When is the best time to apply for a visa extension?

A: You should submit your request while your current visa is still valid, ensuring you leave enough time for processing. If your extension is not granted before your current visa expires, you are required to

depart from India. Staying beyond your validity without an approved extension is considered a wilful illegal overstay and will be handled according to Indian law.

Q: Is it possible to change my visa type after I have arrived?

A: Yes, if you need to convert your visa type, you can submit an application to your jurisdictional FRRO via their e-services portal at <https://indianfrro.gov.in/eservices/home.jsp>. For more specific details on the requirements, you can refer to the Registration Authority section of that website.

Here is the information structured into a clean, conversational Q&A format designed for a chatbot to help users determine their eligibility for an OCI card.

OVERSEAS CITIZEN OF INDIA (OCI) Eligibility FAQ

Q: What is an Overseas Citizen of India (OCI) Cardholder? A: An OCI Cardholder is a foreign national who is officially registered by the Government of India under Section 7A of The Citizenship (Amendment) Act, 2015. The scheme was created to help the Indian Diaspora maintain a strong connection with India through benefits like hassle-free travel and a friendly investment regime.

Q: Who is generally eligible to apply for an OCI card? A: Most foreign nationals of full age and capacity are eligible if they meet one of the following criteria:

- They were an Indian citizen on or after January 26, 1950.
- They were eligible to become an Indian citizen on January 26, 1950.
- They belonged to a territory that became part of India after August 15, 1947.
- They are a child, grandchild, or great-grandchild of someone who meets the above criteria.

Q: Can minor children apply for an OCI card? A: Yes. A minor child is eligible if:

- They are the child of a person eligible for an OCI card.
- Both of their parents are citizens of India, or at least one parent is a citizen of India.

Q: I am the spouse of an Indian citizen. Am I eligible? A: Yes, spouses of foreign origin are eligible if their marriage to an Indian citizen or an existing OCI cardholder has been officially registered and has lasted for a continuous period of at least **two years** immediately before the application is submitted.

Q: What about children born through IVF, surrogacy, or live-in relationships? A: Children born through these circumstances are eligible for OCI registration. However, these applications are reviewed on a **case-to-case basis** and are subject to the specific merits of the case.

Q: Why should I apply for an OCI card? A: The OCI card provides several professional and personal benefits, including:

- Lifelong travel to India without a visa.
- Easier investment opportunities in India.
- Access to various social, economic, and educational fields in the country.

Q: Which nationalities are excluded from applying for an OCI card? A: You are not eligible for an OCI card if you, or any of your parents, grandparents, or great-grandparents, are or were ever citizens of **Pakistan** or **Bangladesh**. This also applies to any other country specifically notified by the Government of India.

Q: Can military or police personnel apply for an OCI card? A: Generally, no. Foreign military or police personnel, whether currently serving or retired, cannot register for an OCI card. The only exception to this rule is for individuals from **Israel**.

Q: What if I am currently undergoing compulsory military service? A: If you are undergoing compulsory military or police

conscription at the time of your application, you will not be eligible for registration during that period. Additionally, if you are applying for an OCI card as a spouse, you are ineligible if you have ever undergone or are currently undergoing such conscription.

Q: Can I apply for an OCI card if I hold a Diplomatic Passport?

A: No. Foreign nationals holding a **Diplomatic Passport** will not be registered as OCI cardholders.

Q: I still have a Person of Indian Origin (PIO) card. Is it still valid?

A: The PIO card scheme has been officially closed. While all existing PIO cardholders are now considered OCI cardholders by law, it is highly recommended that you apply to convert your physical PIO card into an OCI card through the **OCI Miscellaneous Services**.

Q: Under what circumstances must an OCI card be surrendered?

A: If a foreign national registered as an OCI cardholder on the basis of their marriage gets remarried to a different person (either another foreigner or an Indian citizen), they must surrender their existing OCI card to the nearest Indian Mission or FRRO.

Q: Can the Government of India cancel an OCI card? A: Yes. An OCI registration can be cancelled immediately if:

- It was obtained through fraud, false representation, or hiding material facts.
- The holder shows disaffection toward the **Constitution of India**.
- The holder violates any provisions of the **Citizenship Act, 1955**.

Q: Where can I find more details or start an application? A: You can find complete details and access online services at the official OCI portal: <https://ociservices.gov.in>, or by visiting your nearest Indian Mission or FRRO.

Q. Is the OCI card a replacement for my national passport?

A: No. Your foreign passport remains your **primary travel document**. The OCI card is technically a life-long visa, not a travel

document itself. You must carry both your valid national passport and your OCI card at all times while traveling to or staying in India.

Q: Can I stay in India if my national passport expires but my OCI is still valid?

A: No. Staying in India without a valid passport is **illegal**, even for OCI cardholders. You must ensure your foreign passport is valid throughout the duration of your stay in the country.

Q: I heard there are new validity rules for spouses. Is that true?

A: Yes. For OCI cards issued to the spouse of an Indian citizen (or a person of Indian origin) on or after **September 3, 2025**, the card will have an **initial validity of 5 years**. After this period, it can be extended to a life-long visa, subject to government scrutiny.

Q: Do OCI cardholders need to register with the FRRO?

A: Foreigners registered as OCI cardholders are **exempt** from the requirement to register with jurisdictional FRROs, regardless of how long they stay in India.

Q: Do I need a 'U' visa sticker on my passport?

A: No. The 'U' (Universal) visa sticker on the foreign passports of OCI cardholders has been **dispensed with**. Your OCI card itself serves as the proof of your visa status.

Q: Can I apply for an OCI card while I am currently in India?

A: Yes, but you must be an **"Ordinarily Resident."** This means you must have been staying in India for a continuous period of at least **6 months** at the time of your application.

Q: What documents do I need if I apply within India?

A: In addition to the standard forms, you must provide:

- A copy of a **long-duration visa** (not a Tourist, Missionary, or Mountaineering visa) that has at least **3 months of validity** remaining.
- Your **Registration Certificate (RC/RP)** issued by the FRRO/FRO.

Q: Are biometrics required for the application?

A: Yes. It is **mandatory** for all OCI applicants to have their fingerprints and facial biometrics captured (where technically feasible) during the registration process.

Q: What should I do if my birth or marriage certificate was issued outside of India?

A: If these documents are issued by a foreign authority, they must be **Apostilled** or endorsed by the concerned Indian Mission abroad (or the foreign Mission in India) to be considered valid for your application.

Q: How do I get a Police Clearance Certificate (PCC) as an OCI holder?

A: If you are living in India and need a PCC, you must apply to the FRRO/FRO that covers your place of residence. You should indicate the purpose of the certificate and apply via the official portal: <https://indianfrro.gov.in>.

Q: Can I visit any part of India with my OCI card?

A: Generally yes, but OCI cardholders **must obtain** a **Protected Area Permit (PAP)** or **Restricted Area Permit (RAP)** to visit any location designated as a Protected or Restricted Area by the Government of India.

OCI APPLICATION & RIGHTS FAQ

1. How do I submit my OCI application?

Applications for registration as an OCI Cardholder must be submitted online at <https://ociservices.gov.in>. You will find detailed information about the specific documents required for your case on that portal.

2. Do I need to visit the FRRO with hard copies?

Yes. After you have submitted your application online, you are required to bring the **original versions** of all uploaded documents to the concerned FRRO for physical verification.

3. Is a personal interview mandatory?

If you are applying for a **new** OCI registration, a personal interview is mandatory. However, children below the age of **12 years** are exempt from this requirement.

4. When do I provide my biometrics?

- **Applying from abroad:** You can provide biometrics at the application stage at the Mission or upon arrival at the Immigration Check Post in India. However, it is highly recommended to do it during the application stage.
- **Applying in India:** Biometrics must be captured at the application stage at the FRRO.
- **Exemptions:** Applicants above **70 years** or below **12 years** of age are exempt from biometric capturing.

5. Can I collect my OCI card through someone else?

Yes. You can collect it in person or send an authorized representative with your passport. However, if a representative collects it, you must be **physically present** in the country where the OCI card is being issued at the time of collection.

6. What happens to the fee if my application is rejected?

If registration is not granted, an amount of **USD 250** (or local equivalent) will be refunded. Please note that the processing fee (**USD 25** or **₹1400** in India) is non-refundable.

7. Does an OCI cardholder lose their original citizenship?

No. Registering as an OCI cardholder does not affect your current foreign citizenship.

8. What are the limitations for OCI cardholders in India?

While OCI holders enjoy many benefits, there are certain restrictions:

- **Voting:** You are not entitled to vote in Indian elections.
- **Public Office:** You cannot hold constitutional posts (President, Vice-President, Judge of the Supreme Court/High Court) or be a member of Parliament or State Legislatures.

- **Employment:** You are generally not eligible for appointment to public services or government posts.
- **Property:** You cannot acquire agricultural or plantation properties in India.

9. Can OCI cardholders take entrance exams for Indian colleges?

Yes. You are eligible for national entrance tests like **NEET, JEE (Mains/Advanced)**, and others. However, you are not eligible for admission to seats reserved exclusively for Indian citizens.

SPECIAL PERMISSIONS REQUIRED BY OCI CARDHOLDERS

Q: When does an OCI Cardholder require Special Permissions from Indian Mission/FRRO concerned?

A: The OCI Cardholders shall be required to obtain a special permission or a Special Permit, as the case may be, from the competent authority or the Foreigners Regional Registration Officer or the Indian Mission concerned, if they intend to undertake the following:

- i. Research.
- ii. Any missionary or Tabligh or Mountaineering or Journalistic activities;
- iii. Internship in any foreign Diplomatic Missions or foreign Government organizations in India or to take up employment in any foreign Diplomatic Missions in India;
- iv. To visit any place which falls within the Protected or Restricted or Prohibited areas as notified by the Government of India

Points to remember:

OCI Cardholders who are staying abroad and intend to visit India for Research activities are advised to obtain the Special Permit from the concerned Indian Mission abroad before commencing Research in India.

Please visit www.mha.gov.in for more info

Traveling to India: General Guidelines

Q: What is the mandatory arrival procedure for foreigners?

A: You must complete and submit an e-Arrival card online within 72 hours before arrival via <https://indianvisaonline.gov.in/earrival> or the official "Indian Visa Su-Swagatam" mobile app.

Q: Are there specific entry points for Pakistani nationals?

A: Yes. Pakistani nationals arriving by air can only enter India through the International Check Posts (ICPs) in **Delhi, Mumbai, and Chennai**.

Q: What should I check regarding my passport stamps?

A: It is your responsibility to ensure that **Arrival and Departure seals** are affixed to your passport at the immigration counter. If a seal is missed, contact the nearest FRRO or Immigration Post immediately to rectify it.

Q: What activities are strictly prohibited on a Visa or OCI?

A: Foreigners (including OCI holders) are strictly prohibited from engaging in religious preaching, making speeches at religious places, distributing religious pamphlets, or engaging in religious conversion activities.

Q: Are there any health requirements for entry?

A:

- **Yellow Fever:** If you are arriving from or have visited a Yellow Fever endemic country within the last 6 days, you must possess a valid vaccination certificate from an authorized center.
- **Public Health Emergencies:** If arriving from a country with a WHO-declared public health risk, you may be required to undergo medical screening as directed by the Ministry of Health.

Q: What are the rules for Indians traveling from Nepal?

A: Indian citizens traveling from Nepal by air must carry either a valid Indian Passport or an original Indian Voter ID card (EPIC) with a photograph.

Q: Country Specific Guidelines

A: Please visit <https://boi.gov.in/boi/country-specific-guidelines>

Air Crew Travel & Visa FAQ

Q: Do air crew members need a visa to enter India?

A: Yes. Crew members of scheduled and non-scheduled flights, including chartered and special flights, are generally required to obtain a Business Visa or an e-Business Visa of the appropriate duration.

Q: What travel documents are required for crew members of scheduled airlines?

A: Crew members of scheduled airlines operating services to or through India have a specific privilege: they can enter using a valid Crew Member Certificate or License issued by the aircraft's country of registration, instead of a passport.

Q: Are the rules different for non-scheduled or chartered flight crew?

A: Yes. For all crew members of non-scheduled airlines, chartered flights, and special flights, the visa must be endorsed on their national passport. In these cases, a crew member certificate is not an acceptable substitute for a passport.

Q: What are the specific rules for Pakistani Air Crew?

A:

- **Scheduled Services:** Pakistani crew operating scheduled flights between India and Pakistan can land at designated Indian airports without a passport or visa, provided they hold valid personnel licenses.
- **Maintenance Staff:** Aircraft Maintenance Engineers or staff from Pakistani airlines traveling for emergency repairs can land for up to 36 hours without a visa, provided they have a valid passport endorsed for India and appropriate maintenance licenses.

- Stationed Crew: Any Pakistani air crew stationed in India must comply with registration and arrival/departure reporting requirements within 24 hours.

Q: Can Pakistani or Pakistani-origin crew get a Landing Permit if arriving from a third country?

A: No. Pakistani and Pakistani-origin crew members will not be issued a Landing Permit if they arrive in India from any country other than Pakistan.

SEAMEN AND MARITIME CREW FAQ

Q: What documents do I need to Sign On or Sign Off at an Indian seaport?

A: Both Indian and foreign seamen are required to be in possession of two primary documents:

- A valid Passport.
- A Seaman Book or Continuous Discharge Certificate (CDC).

Q: I am a foreign seaman joining a "Foreign Run" vessel in India. Do I need a visa?

A: Yes. Foreign seamen joining vessels that operate on international routes (Foreign Run) must be in possession of a Transit Visa.

Q: What are the visa requirements for joining a "Coastal Run" vessel?

A: If you are joining a vessel operating within Indian coastal waters, the requirements depend on your role:

- General Crew: You must have a Business Visa or an X-Misc. Visa with a specific endorsement to join the vessel (or an OCI card).
- Project Crew: If you are joining specialized vessels such as Survey, Rig, Cable-laying, Seismic, or Research vessels, you must hold an Employment Visa.

Q: Can "Supernumeraries" sign off in India?

A: Foreign Supernumeraries are **not permitted** to Sign Off at an Indian port unless they are in possession of an appropriate and valid visa.

Q: How does the Shore Leave Pass (SLP) work?

A: A Shore Leave Pass may be issued to foreign seamen under the following conditions:

- **Daily Validity:** From 06:00 hrs to 23:45 hrs.
- **Duration:** Valid for a maximum of **7 days** or until the vessel departs, whichever happens first.

Q: Are Supernumeraries eligible for shore leave?

A: No. Foreign Supernumeraries are **not eligible** to receive a Shore Leave Pass (SLP).

Q: What are the restrictions for Pakistani or Pakistani-origin crew?

A: Pakistani nationals and crew members of Pakistani origin will **not** be issued a Landing Permit if they are arriving in India from any country other than Pakistan.

BUSINESS VISA (B) IN INDIA: Frequently Asked Questions

Q: When should I apply for a Business Visa instead of other types?

A: You should apply for a Business Visa if you are visiting India to:

- Establish or explore the possibility of setting up an industrial or business venture.
- Attend technical meetings, board meetings, or general discussions.
- Provide business services support or professional consultations.
- Participate in commercial sports events on contract (such as the IPL, ISL, or IBL), including acting as a coach, where remuneration is involved.

Q: Can I receive a salary in India while on a Business Visa?

A: No. A foreign national on a Business Visa is not permitted to take a salary or remuneration in India. If you are intended to be on an Indian payroll or receive a salary locally, you must apply for an Employment Visa instead.

Q: Do I need to register with the FRRO?

A: Registration with the FRRO/FRO is required if your aggregate stay in India (total days spent in the country) exceeds 180 days during a single calendar year.

Q: What are the requirements for extending a Business Visa?

A: For an extension to be granted, the business must demonstrate a gross sales or turnover of at least ₹1 crore per annum. This financial target must be achieved within 4 years of setting up the business or from the date the initial Business Visa was granted, whichever comes first.

Q: Can I work for a different company than the one listed on my visa?

A: No. You must remain associated with the specific company or organization that provided the visa reference during your application process.

Q: What happens if my visa extension is denied?

A: If your extension is refused, you must leave India immediately or upon the expiry of your current visa validity.

Q: Are there any tax obligations?

A: Yes. Every foreign national conducting business in India is required to comply with all Indian taxation rules and regulations pertaining to their business activities.

Quick Checklist for Business Visitors

- **Primary Purpose:** Business set-up, meetings, or commercial sports.

- **Payment Rule:** No Indian salary permitted (use Employment Visa for salary).
- **Stay Limit:** Register with FRRO if staying over 180 days in a year.
- **Extension Bar:** Must meet the ₹1 crore annual turnover requirement.

Here is the information regarding Medical and Medical Attendant visas in India, structured into a conversational Q&A format for a chatbot.

Medical Treatment & Attendant Visa FAQ

Q: Who needs to apply for a Medical Visa?

A: Any foreign national who wishes to seek medical treatment in India must apply for a Medical Visa. This applies to treatments at established, recognized, or specialized hospitals, as well as accredited centers providing treatment under Indian systems of medicine (such as Ayurveda or Yoga).

Q: Can someone accompany me during my treatment?

A: Yes. Family members or associates accompanying a patient must arrive on a Medical Attendant Visa. This visa is specifically for those providing support to the primary Medical Visa holder.

Q: How many attendants are allowed to travel with a patient?

A: The number of permitted attendants depends on the patient's nationality:

- Most Foreign Nationals: A maximum of two attendants are allowed.
- Bangladesh Nationals: Up to three medical attendants are permitted.
- Pakistan Nationals: Only one medical attendant is allowed.

Q: What are the registration rules for Pakistan nationals?

A: Pakistan nationals holding either a Medical or Medical Attendant visa have stricter registration requirements. They must register themselves with the concerned Foreigners Registration Office (FRO) within **24 hours** of their arrival in India.

Q: Do other foreigners need to register with the FRRO/FRO?

A: Yes, if the visa is valid for a long duration. Foreigners (excluding Pakistan nationals) whose Medical or Medical Attendant visas are valid for **more than 180 days** must register with the FRRO/FRO within **14 days** of their arrival.

Q: Can I change my hospital or treatment center once I am in India?

A: Changing the hospital or place of treatment that was endorsed on your initial visa is generally not allowed. However, it may be permitted on a **case-to-case basis** if you can provide documentary proof that justifies the change.

Q: What documents are typically required for the application?

A: While you should always check the official portal, you will generally need:

- An **official invitation letter** from the recognized Indian hospital.
- Medical documents establishing the need for treatment.
- Proof of sufficient funds for the duration of the stay and treatment.

Medical & Attendant Visa Compliance FAQ

Q: If I'm traveling to India for treatment, what kind of visa do I need, and can someone come with me?

A: If you are the person receiving treatment, you must apply for a Medical Visa. For those accompanying you—whether they are family members or caregivers—they will need to apply for a Medical Attendant Visa. It's important to remember that the attendant's visa is linked directly to yours.

Q: Is there a limit on how many people can come with me as medical attendants?

A: Yes, there are specific limits based on your nationality. For most international travelers, you are allowed up to two attendants. However, if you are a citizen of Bangladesh, you are permitted to bring up to three attendants, while citizens of Pakistan are limited to one attendant only.

Q: Do I need to register with the Indian authorities once I arrive?

A: This depends on your nationality and the length of your stay. For most travelers, registration with the FRRO is only required if your visa is valid for more than 180 days; in this case, you must register within **14 days** of your arrival. However, if you are a citizen of **Pakistan**, the rules are stricter: you must register within **24 hours** of reaching India, regardless of your stay duration.

Q: What exactly is a Medical Attendant Visa?

A: Think of it as a secondary visa for your "escort." It is designed for the person who will be assisting the patient during their medical journey. Because it is a supportive visa, it usually has the same validity period as the patient's primary Medical Visa.

Q: Are there any specific documents the attendant needs to show?

A: Along with their own application, the attendant usually needs a letter from the hospital in India that specifically mentions their name as the designated caregiver for the patient. They may also need to provide proof of their relationship to the patient.

Q: Can I change my attendants once I am already in India?

A: Generally, the attendants who arrive with you are the ones authorized to stay. Changing an attendant while in India is a complex process and is usually only considered in extreme circumstances or emergencies, requiring fresh documentation and approval from the FRRO.

Study in India: Student Visa FAQ

Q. What kind of visa do I need to study in India?

A: If you are pursuing a full-time, structured on-campus course or research at a government-recognized institution, you must obtain a **Student Visa**.

Q. Is there a specific visa for studying Yoga or Indian culture?

A: Yes. If you intend to study **Yoga, Vedic culture, Indian dance, music, or Buddhist studies** at an approved institution, you are required to hold a **Student (S-3) Visa**.

Q. I am coming to India for an internship. Which visa should I apply for?

A: Foreigners joining internships at Indian companies, educational institutions, NGOs, or foreign missions must obtain a **Student (S-6) Visa**.

Q: Are there any types of institutions I should avoid?

A: Yes. You must not enroll in courses offered by:

- Franchise educational institutes running off-campus centers.
- Study centers of Open Universities offering distance learning.
- Institutes running "outreach" programs. Always ensure your institution is duly recognized by the Government of India.

Q. Can I work or start a business while on a Student Visa?

A: No. Foreigners on a Student Visa are **strictly prohibited** from engaging in any employment or business activities in India.

Q. Do I need to register with the FRRO?

A: If your Student Visa is valid for **more than 180 days** (or as per specific stay stipulations on your visa), you must register with the concerned FRRO within **14 days** of your arrival. *Note: Pakistan nationals have different, stricter registration rules.*

Q: What are the financial requirements for students in India?

A: Foreign students are required to open a **Non-Resident Ordinary (NRO) Account** at a recognized bank in India. You must then furnish these account details to the concerned FRRO.

Q: Can I change my college or university after I arrive?

A: A change of institution is generally only allowed under specific circumstances, such as:

- Insufficient infrastructure or facilities.
- Unavailability of the chosen course. You must provide reasonable grounds to the authorities for such a request.

Q: What happens if I stop attending my course?

A: If you discontinue your course for any reason, you must intimate the concerned **FRRO immediately**.

Q: Are there any travel restrictions for students?

A: If your educational institution is located in a designated Restricted or Protected Area, you must obtain a RAP/PAP permit before traveling to that location.

Q: What is the "Study in India" (SII) scheme?

The SII scheme is a government initiative to help foreign students apply to top-tier Indian institutes. You can find more details and register at <https://studyinindia.gov.in>.

TOURISM IN INDIA: Frequently Asked Questions

Q: When should I apply for a Tourist Visa?

A: You should apply for a Tourist Visa if your sole objective for visiting India is:

- Recreation or sightseeing.
- A casual visit to meet friends or relatives.
- Attending a short-term yoga program (up to 6 months).
- Short-duration medical treatment (including Indian systems of medicine).

Q: I am traveling with a large group. Is there a specific visa for us?

A: Yes. If you are traveling in a group of 4 or more members through a recognized Travel Agency, you may be eligible for a Group Tourist Visa.

Q: How long can I stay in India on a Tourist Visa?

A: The maximum aggregate stay for a foreigner in a single calendar year (whether on a regular Tourist Visa, an e-Tourist Visa, or both) cannot exceed **180 days**. Additionally, you must adhere to the specific continuous stay stay-stipulation limit endorsed on your visa upon arrival.

Q: Can I extend my Tourist Visa or change it to another type?

A: No. An e-Tourist or regular Tourist Visa is **non-extendable and non-convertible**. Once the visa expires or your permitted stay is over, you must depart the country.

Q: Can I participate in tourist activities if I am on a different type of visa?

A: Yes. Foreign nationals (except Pakistani nationals) who arrive in India on any other type of visa (such as a Business or Student visa) are permitted to engage in activities typically allowed under a Tourist Visa.

Q: What counts as a "short-term yoga programme"?

A: A short-term yoga program is defined as one that does not exceed **6 months** in duration and does not result in the issuance of a formal qualifying certificate or diploma.

Q: Is there a mandatory gap between two visits?

A: For most travelers, there is no longer a gap requirement. However, a gap of at least **2 months** is mandatory between two visits for nationals of the following countries:

- Afghanistan, China, Iraq, and Sudan.
- Foreigners of Pakistani origin and stateless persons.

QUICK COMPLIANCE CHECKLIST FOR TOURISTS FAQ

Q: Is there a limit on how long I can stay in India on a Tourist Visa in a single year?

A: Yes. The maximum time a foreigner can stay in India on a Tourist or e-Tourist Visa is 180 days total within a single calendar year (January to December). Even if you have a multi-year visa, you must ensure your combined visits don't cross this 180-day threshold.

Q: Can I extend my Tourist Visa if I want to stay longer?

A: No. Under standard rules, Tourist and e-Tourist Visas are strictly non-extendable. You must depart the country before your permitted stay or visa validity expires.

Q: Am I allowed to convert my Tourist Visa into a Student or Work Visa while I'm in India?

A: Generally, no. Conversion of a Tourist Visa into any other visa type is not permitted while you are inside the country. If your purpose of stay changes, you usually need to leave India and apply for the correct visa category from abroad.

Q: Is there a mandatory gap required between two visits to India?

A: For most nationalities, there is no longer a mandatory "two-month gap" between visits. However, a 2-month gap between arrivals is still strictly required for nationals of Afghanistan, China, Iraq, Sudan, and Iran, as well as for stateless persons and foreigners of Pakistani origin.

Q: Can I take a yoga course while on a Tourist Visa?

A: Yes, you can attend a short-term yoga program on a Tourist Visa, provided the course does not exceed 6 months in duration. Please note that these should be casual or experiential courses; the Tourist Visa does not cover structured programs that result in a formal diploma or qualifying certificate.

VISA-FREE ENTRY TO INDIA: Frequently Asked Questions

Q: Which countries are exempt from the Indian visa requirement?

A: Citizens of **Nepal, Bhutan, and the Maldives** are eligible for visa-free entry into India under specific conditions.

Q: Under what conditions can Maldivian citizens enter India without a visa?

A: Maldivian nationals can avail of visa-free entry exclusively for Tourism, Medical treatment, or Business purposes, provided their stay does not exceed 90 days.

Q: How is the 90-day stay calculated for Maldivians?

A: The 90-day limit is cumulative. It includes all prior stays in India during the **6 months immediately preceding** your current date of arrival. If you intend to stay longer than 90 days, you must apply for a Regular Visa.

Q: Can Maldivian seamen use the visa-free entry to "Sign-On" to a vessel?

A: No. The "Sign-On" facility is not available to seamen who enter India under the visa-free regime.

Q: Do citizens of Nepal and Bhutan need a passport to enter India?

A: If they are visiting India directly **from Nepal or Bhutan** (by land or air), they are exempt from holding a passport or visa. However, they must carry a government-approved photo ID that authenticates their nationality (such as a Voter ID).

Q: When is a passport mandatory for Nepalese or Bhutanese citizens?

A: A valid passport is required in the following scenarios:

- When entering or exiting India from/to a **third country** (any country other than Nepal, Bhutan, or India).
- When entering India specifically from **China, Macau, Hong Kong, or Pakistan**. In these cases, a passport and a valid Indian visa are mandatory.

Q: What details must the identification document contain?

A: If not using a passport, the alternative document must include:

- Given Name and Last Name.
- Date of Birth and Nationality.
- Photograph.
- Issuing Authority and Period of Validity.

VISA-FREE ENTRY QUICK REFERENCE FAQ

Q: What are the visa rules for Maldivian citizens visiting India?

A: Citizens of the Maldives can enter India without a visa for tourism, medical treatment, or business purposes. This stay is limited to 90 days within any 6-month period, and travellers must be in possession of a valid passport.

Q: Do citizens of Nepal need a passport to enter India?

A: Not necessarily. If a Nepalese citizen is entering India directly from Nepal, there is no limit on their stay and they can use either a valid passport or a government-issued photo ID that proves their nationality. However, if they are entering India from a third country, a passport and visa become mandatory.

Q: What documents are required for Bhutanese citizens traveling to India?

A: Similar to Nepalese citizens, Bhutanese nationals traveling directly from Bhutan do not have a stay limit and can enter using a government-issued photo ID or a passport. If they arrive from a country other than Bhutan or India, they must have a valid passport and an Indian visa.

Q: Are there special rules for Nepalese or Bhutanese citizens arriving from places like China or Pakistan?

A: Yes. Even though there is a visa-free regime for these citizens, if they are entering India from China, Macau, Hong Kong, or Pakistan, they are strictly required to be in possession of both a valid passport and a visa for India.

Q: What happens if a Maldivian citizen needs to stay in India for more than 90 days?

A: The visa-free facility for Maldivians is strictly capped at 90 days (which includes any time spent in India during the previous 6 months). If the intended visit is longer than 90 days, a regular Indian visa must be obtained before arrival.

EMPLOYMENT VISA: FAQ

General Eligibility & Requirements

Q: What type of visa do I need to work in India?

A: Foreigners desiring to work in India must arrive on a valid Employment Visa. This is typically reserved for highly skilled or qualified professionals.

Q: Who is eligible for an Employment Visa?

A: You are eligible if you are being engaged or appointed by:

- An Indian company, organization, or industry.
- A foreign firm engaged in the execution of a project in India.

Q: Is there a minimum salary requirement for working in India?

A: Yes. Foreigners must draw a gross salary exceeding Rs. 16.25 lakhs per annum.

Note: Some specific sectors notified by the Government of India (GOI) may be exempt from this annual floor limit.

Non-Profit & Volunteer Work

Q: Do I need a visa for voluntary work or NGOs?

A: Yes. If you intend to work with a Non-Profit or NGO on a voluntary basis (with or without an honorarium), you must obtain an Employment (E-3) Visa.

Q: Is there a limit on the stipend for volunteers?

A: Yes, if an honorarium is paid, it is subject to a ceiling of Rs. 10,000 per month.

Business Owners & Promoters

Q: I own the majority stake in a company; do I need an Employment Visa?

A: No. If you are a promoter or owner of a company holding majority stakes/shareholdings, you are required to enter India on a Business Visa.

Restrictions & Compliance

Q: Can I change my employer while in India?

A: No. A change of employer is not permitted during the currency of your employment visa. To change jobs, you must leave India and apply for a fresh Employment Visa.

Q: Can I work for two companies at the same time?

A: No. Foreigners are prohibited from working for more than one company simultaneously on an Employment Visa.

Q: What happens if I resign or lose my job?

A: You must inform the FRRO/FRO (Foreigners Regional Registration Office) concerned immediately if you discontinue your employment.

Q: What are my legal obligations while working in India?

A: You must comply with all Indian legal requirements, including meeting the minimum salary threshold and fulfilling all tax liabilities.

Q1: I'm a professional and I've been offered a job in India. What visa should I apply for?

A: You should apply for an Employment Visa. This visa is specifically for highly skilled or qualified professionals who have been appointed by an Indian company or a foreign firm working on a project in India.

Q2: I want to volunteer at an NGO in India. Is there a specific visa for that?

A: Yes, even for voluntary work, you need an Employment (E-3) Visa. This applies whether you are working for free or receiving a small honorarium (which is capped at Rs. 10,000 per month).

Q3: If I own the majority of shares in a company I'm starting in India, do I still need an Employment Visa?

A: No, in that case, you should enter on a Business Visa. If you are a promoter or a majority shareholder/owner of a company, the Business Visa is the correct category for your entry.

Q4: Can I switch to a different company while I'm already in India on an Employment Visa?

A: Unfortunately, no. You aren't allowed to change employers while your current visa is active. If you decide to take a job with a different company, you must leave India and apply for a fresh Employment Visa under your new employer.

Q5: Is it possible to work for two different Indian companies at the same time?

A: No, that is not permitted. Under the terms of an Employment Visa, you are only allowed to work for one company at a time.

Q6: Are there any specific salary requirements I should know about?

A: Yes, generally you must earn a gross salary of more than Rs. 16.25 lakhs per year to qualify for an Employment Visa. However, the government does exempt certain sectors from this rule from time to time, so it's worth checking if your specific industry is on that list.

Q7: What do I need to do if I quit my job or my contract ends?

A: If you discontinue your employment, you (or your employer) must inform the concerned FRRO/FRO office. Additionally, you are responsible for ensuring all legal requirements are met before you leave, such as paying your final tax liabilities.

INDIA TRANSIT VISA: FAQ

General Transit Rules

Q: I'm just passing through India to another country. Do I need a Transit Visa?

A: Yes, if your sole purpose is to travel through India to a destination outside the country, a Transit Visa is required. However, there are specific exceptions for air and sea travelers who stay within designated areas.

Q: How long is a Transit Visa valid for?

A: Ordinarily, it is valid for a single journey and must be used for entry within 15 days from the date it was issued. Note that its validity will never exceed the validity of the visa you hold for your final destination country.

Q: How long can I stay in India on a Transit Visa?

A: A Transit Visa is only for "direct transit." This means each visit cannot exceed 3 days. If you plan to stay in India for more than 72 hours, you must apply for an appropriate visa category (like a Tourist Visa).

Air & Sea Travel Exceptions

Q: I have a layover at an Indian airport. Do I need a visa if I don't leave the airport?

A: You do not need a Transit Visa if you are in direct transit by air and remain within the specified precincts of the airport for less than 24 hours. If your layover exceeds 24 hours, or if you need to leave the

airport precincts (e.g., to stay at a hotel outside), a Transit Visa is required.

Q: I'm traveling by ship. Do I need a visa when we dock at an Indian port?

A: No, a Transit Visa is not required as long as you do not leave the ship while it is at the port.

Q: Can I leave my ship to catch a flight from a nearby airport?

A: Yes, but only with prior approval from the competent authority. You must hold a valid ticket for a scheduled air service and will only be allowed to leave the ship to proceed directly to the designated airport.

Important Restrictions & Extensions

Q: What happens if I don't travel within the 15-day validity period?

A: If you do not perform your journey through India within the validity period of your Transit Visa, the visa will lapse. You will need to apply and pay for a fresh Transit Visa.

Q: Can I extend my Transit Visa if my plans change?

A: Generally, no. Transit Visas are not extendable. Extensions are only granted in extreme emergencies, such as medical illness, inclement weather, or major strikes/traffic disruptions.

Q: Can I use a Transit Visa to do a quick 4-day tour?

A: No. If you intend to stay in India for more than 3 days for any reason, you must obtain a visa of the appropriate category, such as an e-Tourist Visa.

India Transit Regulations

Q: I have a layover in India. Do I always need a Transit Visa?

A: Not necessarily. If you are traveling by air and staying inside the airport's transit area for less than 24 hours, you do not need a visa. However, if your layover is longer than 24 hours or you plan to leave the airport, you must have a Transit Visa.

Q: How long can I actually stay in the country on a Transit Visa?

A: A Transit Visa is strictly for short stops. You can stay for a maximum of 3 days (72 hours) per visit. If you plan to be in India for more than 3 days, you'll need to apply for a different category, like a Tourist Visa.

Q: I am traveling by sea. Do I need a visa when the ship stops at an Indian port?

A: If you stay on board the ship while it is docked, you do not need a visa. If you intend to leave the ship to catch a flight, you will need a visa and prior approval from the competent authorities to proceed to the airport.

Q: How long is the Transit Visa valid once it is issued?

A: Generally, a Transit Visa is valid for a single journey and must be used within 15 days of being issued. Also, keep in mind that its validity cannot exceed the validity of the visa you hold for your final destination country.

Q: My flight was delayed due to bad weather. Can I extend my Transit Visa?

A: Normally, Transit Visas cannot be extended. However, exceptions are made for extreme emergencies such as inclement weather, strikes, or medical illness. Outside of these rare cases, the 3-day limit is firm.

Q: What happens if I don't use my Transit Visa within the 15-day window?

A: If you don't perform your journey within that period, the visa becomes invalid. You cannot renew it; you would have to apply and pay for a fresh Transit Visa.

Q: Can I leave the airport to stay at a hotel for two nights on this visa?

A: Yes! As long as your stay is under 3 days, a Transit Visa allows you to leave the airport precincts. If your hotel stay or visit exceeds 3

days, you must obtain an appropriate category visa, such as a Tourist Visa, before you arrive.

FOREIGNERS/PERSONS OF INDIAN ORIGIN (FIO)

Q: What exactly does it mean to be a "Foreigner of Indian Origin" (FIO)?

A: You are considered a Foreigner of Indian Origin if you meet one of two criteria:

- a. You have held an Indian passport at any time in the past.
- b. You, or any of your parents, grandparents, or great-grandparents, were born in and were permanent residents of India.

Q: Are there any countries that are excluded from this FIO definition?

A: Yes. Even if you have Indian ancestry, you are generally not eligible for this status if you (or the ancestors you are tracing through) have ever been a citizen of Afghanistan, Bangladesh, China, Pakistan, or Sri Lanka. The Government of India may also specify other countries from time to time.

Q: Which visa is best for an FIO visiting India?

A: The most appropriate category is the Entry (X-1) Visa. While FIOs can apply for other visas (like Tourist or Business) depending on their specific purpose, the X-1 visa is specifically designed for people of Indian origin and their families.

Q: Who else is eligible for the X-1 Entry Visa besides the FIO themselves?

A: The X-1 Visa is also available to:

- The spouses and children of Indian Citizens, FIOs, or OCI (Overseas Citizen of India) cardholders, even if those children were born in a foreign country.
- People of Indian origin from former French territories, specifically those born in Puducherry, Mahe, and Yanam.

Q: Can I use an X-1 Visa if I want to work or start a business in India?

A: No. The X-1 Visa is primarily for visiting and staying with family. If your purpose is professional, you should apply for an Employment or Business Visa, even if you are of Indian origin.

Q: What is the difference between an FIO and an OCI cardholder?

A: "Foreigner of Indian Origin" is a general description of your heritage. An OCI (Overseas Citizen of India) is a specific, lifelong status you apply for that grants you a "lifelong visa" and many of the same rights as Indian citizens (excluding voting and buying agricultural land). Most FIOs prefer to get an OCI card because it eliminates the need to apply for a visa every time they visit.

RESTRICTED & PROTECTED AREA PERMITS

Q: Can foreigners visit any part of India they wish?

A: Generally, yes, but certain regions are classified as Protected Areas or Restricted Areas. Foreigners are not normally allowed to visit these zones unless they have extraordinary reasons and the proper permits.

Q: Which areas in India require a special permit (RAP/PAP)?

A: You will need a permit (Restricted Area Permit or Protected Area Permit) to visit the following:

- Entire States/UTs: Arunachal Pradesh, Manipur, Mizoram, Nagaland, and the Andaman & Nicobar Islands.
- Specific Parts of States: Parts of Himachal Pradesh, Jammu & Kashmir, Rajasthan, Uttarakhand, and Sikkim (which is partly Protected and partly Restricted).

Q: How do I apply for a RAP or PAP?

A: The application process depends on where you are currently located:

- Outside India: Apply through your nearest Indian Mission (Embassy/Consulate) at least 30 days before your planned visit.
- Already in India: Apply to the jurisdictional FRRO (Foreigners Regional Registration Office) at least 15 days in advance.

Q: If I have a permit, can I go anywhere within that restricted area?

A: Not necessarily. A RAP/PAP grants you entry to the general region, but you may still need additional permission from the specific officer in charge of certain installations, national parks, or specific islands within that area.

Q: What are the consequences of visiting these areas without a permit?

A: Visiting a Restricted or Protected area without a valid permit is a serious legal offense. Under the Immigration and Foreigners Act, 2025, strict action will be taken against anyone found in violation of these security protocols.

Q: Are there any group requirements for these permits?

A: Yes, in many cases (especially for PAP), tourists are required to travel in groups of at least two people and must be accompanied by a registered travel agent. Independent travel to certain zones may be restricted.

Q: Is the list of restricted areas permanent?

A: No. The Government of India updates these locations from time to time. Always check with the local FRRO or the Indian Embassy for the most current list of notified places before you finalize your itinerary.

IMMIGRATION FOR INDIAN CITIZENS

Q: Do Indian citizens need to go through immigration when traveling abroad?

A: Yes. Indian citizens are required to obtain immigration clearance both when arriving in India and when departing for a foreign country.

Q: What documents do I need to carry when leaving India?

A: To clear immigration at departure, you must carry:

- A valid Indian Passport.
- A valid Visa for your destination country.

- Any other specific clearances required for your travel (such as OCI cards for family members or specific health declarations).

Q: I used an e-Gate at the airport, but my passport wasn't stamped. Is this a problem?

A: No, it's perfectly normal! If you use the automated e-Gates (part of the Fast Track Immigration program), the system processes your clearance digitally. Your passport will not receive a physical ink stamp.

Q: How can I check my travel history if my passport isn't stamped?

A: You can view your arrival and departure details online. Simply log in to your Fast Track Immigration (FTI-TTP) profile on the official website: ftittp.mha.gov.in.

Q5: What is the FTI-TTP program mentioned on the website?

A: It stands for the Fast Track Immigration – Trusted Traveller Programme. It's a government initiative that allows pre-verified Indian nationals and OCI cardholders to use biometric e-gates for faster, contactless immigration clearance.

PROTECTOR OF EMIGRANTS (POE) OFFICE DIRECTORY

1. Delhi Office

- Location: ISIL Building, VK Krishna Menon Bhawan, 4th Floor, 9 Bhagwandas Road, New Delhi-110001.
- Contact: 011-23382472 / 23073908 | poedelhi@mea.gov.in
- Jurisdiction: Delhi, Uttarakhand, parts of Uttar Pradesh (Shamli, Meerut, Ghaziabad, etc.), parts of Haryana (Gurgaon, Faridabad, etc.), and parts of Rajasthan (Alwar, Bharatpur).

2. Rae Bareli Office

- Location: 1st Floor, Rudra Plaza, Hospital Road, Rae Bareli, Uttar Pradesh.
- Contact: 0535-2211122 | poerbl@mea.gov.in
- Jurisdiction: Covers the state of Uttar Pradesh.

3. Jaipur Office

- Location: CFC Building, RIICO, Sitapura Industrial Area, Sitapura, India Gate, Tonk Road, Jaipur, Rajasthan.
- Contact: 0141-2771528 | poejaipur@mea.gov.in
- Jurisdiction: Covers the state of Rajasthan.

4. Chandigarh Office

- Location: 5th Block, Ground Floor, Room No. 27, Kendriya Sadan, Sector-9A, Chandigarh-160017.
- Contact: 0172-2741790 | poechd@mea.gov.in
- Jurisdiction: Punjab, Haryana, Chandigarh, Himachal Pradesh, and Jammu & Kashmir.

5. Mumbai Office

- Location: 4th Floor, "Videsh Bhavan," BKC, Plot No C-45, G Block, Bandra (East), Mumbai-400051.
- Contact: 022-26520023 | poemumbai@mea.gov.in
- Jurisdiction: Maharashtra, Gujarat, Goa, Madhya Pradesh, and UTs of Dadra & Nagar Haveli and Daman & Diu.

6. Kolkata Office

- Location: Room No. 18, A-Wing, MSO Building, 3rd Floor, DF Block, Salt Lake, Kolkata-700084.
- Contact: 033-23343407 | poekol@mea.gov.in
- Jurisdiction: West Bengal, Odisha, Chhattisgarh, Sikkim, and Andaman & Nicobar Islands.

7. Hyderabad Office

- Location: Regional Passport Office Building, 2nd Floor, 73, Red Cross Road, Shivaji Nagar, Secunderabad-500003.
- Contact: 040-27772557 | poehyd@mea.gov.in
- Jurisdiction: Andhra Pradesh and Telangana.

8. Chennai Office

- Location: Rayala Towers, Tower 2, 4th Floor, Anna Salai, Chennai-600078.
- Contact: 044-29862069 | poechennai1@mea.gov.in
- Jurisdiction: Tamil Nadu and Puducherry.

9. Trivandrum Office

- Location: 5th Floor, NORKA Centre, Thycaud, Thiruvananthapuram-695014.
- Contact: 0471-2336625 | poetvm2@mea.gov.in
- Jurisdiction: Southern Kerala districts (Thiruvananthapuram, Kollam, Pathanamthitta, Kottayam, Idukki, Alappuzha).

10. Cochin Office

- Location: Ground Floor, RPO Building, Panampilli Nagar, Cochin.
- Contact: 0484-2360187 | poecochin@mea.gov.in
- Jurisdiction: Northern Kerala districts (Ernakulam, Thrissur, Kozhikode, etc.) and Lakshadweep.

11. Patna Office

- Location: 5th Floor, A Block, Niyojan Bhawan, Bailey Road, Patna-800001.
- Contact: poepatna@mea.gov.in
- Jurisdiction: Bihar and Jharkhand.

12. Bengaluru Office

- Location: RPO Building, 8th Block, 80 Feet Road, KHB Games Village, Koramangala, Bengaluru-560095.
- Contact: poebengaluru@mea.gov.in
- Jurisdiction: Karnataka and Goa.

13. Guwahati Office

- Location: RPO Building, Rani Bagan, Basistha Road, 3rd Bylane, Guwahati-781028.
- Contact: 8287020033 | poeguwahati@mea.gov.in

- Jurisdiction: Arunachal Pradesh, Assam, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Manipur, Nagaland, and Tripura.

POE Clearance

Q: What is "Emigration Clearance" and who needs it?

A: Emigration Clearance is a legal requirement under the Emigration Act, 1983. It is mandatory for Indian passport holders in the ECR (Emigration Check Required) category who are traveling to specific countries for employment.

Q: Which countries require me to get POE clearance before I fly for work?

A: Currently, there are 18 countries where clearance is required for ECR passport holders:

- Middle East: UAE, Saudi Arabia (KSA), Qatar, Oman, Kuwait, Bahrain, Jordan, Yemen, Syria, Lebanon, Iraq, Iran.
- Africa: Libya, Sudan.
- Asia: Malaysia, Indonesia, Thailand, Afghanistan.

Q: Is it true that I cannot travel to Iraq for work?

A: Yes, currently emigration to Iraq is banned. Even for those with ECNR passports, traveling to Iraq for work usually requires special government clearance or is restricted due to security concerns.

Q: How do I know if my passport is "ECR" or "ECNR"?

A: Look at the last page of your passport.

- If it has an endorsement saying "Emigration Check Required," you are in the ECR category.
- If there is no such endorsement, or if it explicitly says "ECNR" (or refers to the holder as being in a non-ECR category), you do not need POE clearance for travel.

Q: I have an ECR passport, but I'm just going to the UAE for a 10-day holiday. Do I still need clearance?

A: No. Since October 1st, 2007, ECR passport holders traveling for purposes other than employment (like tourism, visiting family, or study) do not need POE clearance. You simply need your valid passport, a valid visa, and a return ticket to show at the immigration counter.

Q: Are there any professional groups that always need clearance, regardless of their passport status?

A: Yes. Even if you have an ECNR passport, you must obtain POE clearance if you fall into these specific categories and are traveling to any of the 18 ECR countries:

- Nurses traveling for work.
- Seafarers traveling to join a vessel abroad.
- Anyone traveling to Iraq (due to the current restrictions).

Q: Can I apply for this clearance online?

A: Yes. As of 2026, the process is fully digital through the eMigrate portal. You will need to upload your employment contract, your visa, and proof of your PBBY (Pravasi Bhartiya Bima Yojana) insurance.

SEAFARERS AND E-MIGRATE

Q: What is the e-Migrate system for seafarers?

A: The e-Migrate system is a mandatory digital platform launched by the Directorate General of Shipping (DGS). It is designed to track and protect Indian seafarers, particularly those recruited for foreign-flagged vessels.

Q: Why was this system introduced?

A: It was created to prevent seafarers from being exploited by unlicensed Recruitment & Placement Services (RPS). By using e-Migrate, the government ensures that every seafarer is placed through a legitimate agency and has a valid contract.

Q: Who is required to go through the e-Migrate process?

A: Every Indian seafarer leaving an Indian seaport or airport to join a ship—regardless of rank—must be cleared through the e-Migrate system.

Q: What happens if I try to join a ship without e-Migrate clearance?

A: You will not be allowed to board your vessel or continue your service. Immigration authorities at airports and seaports strictly verify e-Migrate status before allowing seafarers to depart.

Q: Are there any exemptions to this rule?

A: Generally, no, unless specifically exempted by the DGS guidelines (such as certain specialized personnel who are not categorized as "seafarers" under the Maritime Labour Convention). However, for the vast majority of active crew members, it is a mandatory requirement.

Q: I am traveling through Mumbai Airport. Is there help available for this?

A: Yes. As of 2026, there is a 24/7 Seafarers Facilitation Counter at Terminal 2 (Mumbai Airport). They can assist with document verification and help resolve any e-Migrate issues before you reach immigration.

Q: Where can I find more details or check my e-Migrate status?

A: You should visit the official website of the Directorate General of Shipping at www.dgshipping.gov.in. You can also manage your profile through the updated e-Samudra portal, which handles seafarer data as of 2026.

Q: Visa on arrival countries:

A: Please visit <https://www.mea.gov.in/images/amb1/visa-facility-for-indian-nationals.pdf>

GOVERNMENT OF INDIA TRAVEL RESTRICTIONS

Q: Which countries are currently subject to travel bans or major restrictions by India?

A: As of 2026, the Government of India maintains strict travel advisories and bans for Iraq, Yemen, and Libya due to ongoing security threats and volatile regional situations.

Q: I am planning a trip to Iraq. Are there any specific areas I must avoid?

A: Yes. Indian nationals are strictly advised not to travel to the following five provinces due to extreme security risks:

- Nineveh
- Salahuddin
- Diyala
- Anbar
- Kirkuk

Q: What if I have a job offer in a safer part of Iraq?

A: For employment in provinces *other* than the five listed above, you must follow these two mandatory steps:

1. Register on the e-Migrate portal of the Government of India.
2. Inform the Embassy of India in Baghdad or the Consulate General of India in Erbil before you travel.

Q: Is there a total ban on traveling to Yemen?

A: Yes. A travel ban remains in place for all Indian passport holders. Per the MEA notification from September 2017, Indian nationals are prohibited from traveling to Yemen due to the severe conflict and lack of safety.

Q: What is the current rule for traveling to Libya?

A: Following a modification in August 2024, the total ban was eased to allow only essential travel. Indian nationals are urged to avoid all non-essential visits. If you must travel for essential reasons:

- Maintain regular contact with the Indian Embassy in Tripoli.
- Avoid inter-province road travel.
- Exercise extreme caution at all times.

Q: Where can I find the most up-to-date travel advisories for other countries?

A: You should always check the "Travel Advisory" section on the official website of the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) at www.mea.gov.in. These advisories are updated frequently based on global security developments.

NEPAL ENTRY REQUIREMENTS FOR INDIAN CITIZENS

Q: Do Indian citizens need a visa or passport to enter Nepal?

A: No. Indian citizens do not require a visa or a passport to enter Nepal, whether traveling by land or by air. However, you must carry specific identity documents to prove your citizenship.

Q: What documents are accepted for Indian adults traveling to Nepal by air?

A: To establish your identity as an Indian citizen when flying, you should carry one of the following:

- A valid Indian Passport.
- A Voter ID Card (Election ID) issued by the Election Commission of India.
- A Photo Identity Card issued to employees by the Government of India, State Government, or UT Administration.

Q: What documents are required for minor children traveling with their parents?

A: Minor children accompanied by parents (who have their own valid ID) can travel by showing any one of these original documents to prove their age and relationship:

- Birth Certificate
- Aadhaar Card
- Ration Card issued by the Government of India
- Photo ID Card issued by their School or College

Q: I lost my documents while in Nepal. How can I return to India?

A: If you are in Nepal and lose your identification, you should contact the Embassy of India in Kathmandu. They can issue an Emergency

Certificate or an Identity Certificate specifically for a single journey back to India.

Q: Can family members of government employees use their office-issued IDs?

A: Yes. Photo Identity Cards issued by the Central/State Government or UT Administrations to their employees and their dependent family members are considered valid for travel between India and Nepal.

BHUTAN ENTRY REQUIREMENTS FOR INDIAN CITIZENS

Q: Do Indian citizens need a visa to visit Bhutan?

A: No, Indian nationals do not require a visa to enter Bhutan. However, you must obtain an Entry Permit upon arrival.

Q: Where can I get my Entry Permit?

A: If you are entering by land via the border town of Phuentsholing, the Department of Immigration issues these permits at the Pedestrian Terminal. If you are flying into Paro, the permit is processed at the airport's immigration counter.

Q: What documents do I need to carry for the Entry Permit?

A: You must carry one of the following two original documents:

- An Original Indian Passport (must have at least six months of validity remaining).
- An Original Voter ID Card (issued by the Election Commission of India).

Q: What are the requirements for children under 18 years old?

A: Children who do not have a passport or Voter ID must carry their Original Birth Certificate (it must be in English). Additionally, minors must be accompanied by a legal guardian.

Q: Can I use my Aadhaar Card or Driving License to enter Bhutan?

A: No. According to the official guidelines, only the Passport or Voter ID Card are accepted as valid travel documents for adults. Other

forms of ID like Aadhaar [Redacted] or a Driving License are not sufficient for the issuance of an Entry Permit.

Q: Is there a fee for Indian tourists visiting Bhutan?

A: Yes. While there is no "visa fee," Indian tourists are required to pay a Sustainable Development Fee (SDF). As of the current regulations, this fee is Rs. 1,200 per person per night. Children aged 6 to 12 typically receive a 50% concession, and those under 5 are exempt.

Q: Where can I find more specific details about Bhutan's immigration policies?

A: For the most detailed and up-to-date information, you should visit the official website of the Department of Immigration (Government of Bhutan) at www.doi.gov.bt.

IMMIGRATION & EXIT REGULATIONS FOR FOREIGNERS

Q: What is the primary advice for a foreigner regarding entry and departure points in India?

A: A foreigner is strongly advised to travel only through authorized Immigration Posts. Upon crossing the border, the foreigner must ensure that their passport is physically stamped by the Immigration authorities to maintain a legal record of their movement.

Q: What travel documents must a foreigner carry when departing India for another country?

A: Unless specifically exempted, a foreigner requires a valid passport and a valid visa (including a Transit Visa, if applicable) for their final destination country.

Q: Under what circumstances must a foreigner obtain an Exit Permit?

A: An Exit Permit is mandatory for a foreigner in the following scenarios:

- If the foreigner was issued a One-Time Travel Document or a *Laissez-Passer*.

- If the foreigner has overstayed the duration allowed by their visa or stay stipulation.
- If the foreigner is involved in an inter-country or international adoption of a child.

Q: Can a foreigner use an OCI card for departure if it was issued by an Indian Embassy abroad while the foreigner was already in India?

A: No. If a foreigner arrived on a standard Indian visa and subsequently had an OCI card issued by an embassy abroad, that card cannot be used to leave the country. The foreigner must either:

1. Depart India within the validity of their original visa.
2. Obtain an Exit Permit from the jurisdictional FRRO.

Q: What is the rule if the OCI card was issued to the foreigner within India?

A: If the OCI card was issued by an FRRO in India, the foreigner may continue their stay indefinitely and depart at their convenience using the newly issued OCI card. No Exit Permit is required in this case.

Q: Where can a foreigner find more information regarding registration and local authorities?

A: For more detailed guidance, a foreigner should visit the Registration Authority page on the official immigration website to identify their jurisdictional FRRO.

Q: What are the travel requirements for Nepal Citizens

A: No Objection Certificate (NOC) mandatory for travelling to Kingdom of Saudi Arabia (KSA), Qatar, Kuwait, UAE, Oman, Bahrain, Iraq, Libya & Lebanon from India. NOC can be obtained from Embassy of Nepal in India. This regulation does not apply to those transiting India.

TRANSIT REGULATIONS FOR PAKISTANI NATIONALS

Q: Does a Pakistani national always need a visa to transit through an Indian airport or seaport?

A: No. A visa is not required if the Pakistani national is in direct transit and remains strictly within the designated international transit area of the airport or seaport.

Q: When must a Pakistani national apply for an Indian Transit Visa?

A: A Transit Visa is required if the foreigner has a connecting flight to a third country at major International Check Posts (ICPs) such as Mumbai, Delhi, or Chennai, and needs to leave the transit area.

Q: Is there an option for a Pakistani national who is returning to Pakistan via India?

A: Yes. If the foreigner is traveling to a third country and returning to Pakistan via an Indian airport, they may apply for a double-entry transit visa.

Q: How long can a Pakistani national stay in India on a Transit Visa?

A: The stay during a single entry on an Indian transit visa must not exceed 36 hours.

Q: Does a Pakistani national on a transit visa need to register with the police or immigration?

A: No. Foreigners from Pakistan who are traveling on a transit visa are exempt from registration and do not need to report to the police.

Q: Can a Pakistani national enter via the Wagah/Attari land border on a transit visa to catch a flight from Amritsar or Delhi?

A: No. A foreigner cannot enter through the Wagah/Attari land border on a transit visa for the purpose of boarding an international flight from Amritsar or Delhi.

Q: Is it permissible to enter via the land border and drive immediately to an airport for a flight to a third country?

A: No. Entry through a land border for immediate travel to an airport to board a flight to a third country is not permitted under a transit visa.

TRAVEL REGULATIONS FOR PERSONS OF TIBETAN ORIGIN

Q: What is the primary travel document required for a person of Tibetan origin in India to travel abroad?

A: A person of Tibetan origin must travel strictly on the strength of a Certificate of Identity (COI) issued by the Ministry of External Affairs, Government of India.

Q: Can a person of Tibetan origin travel using a different type of travel document?

A: No. If a person of Tibetan origin travels from India using any travel document other than the official Certificate of Identity, they will become ineligible for long-term status in India upon their return.

Q: What documents must a person of Tibetan origin possess before departing India?

A: To travel abroad, the following documents are mandatory:

- A valid Certificate of Identity (COI).
- A valid Visa and all necessary documentation for the destination country.
- A One-year multiple entry Return Visa issued by the jurisdictional FRRO.
- An Exit Permit (required if the stay abroad will exceed 15 days).

Q: Is a "Return Visa" mandatory for returning to India?

A: Yes. A foreigner of Tibetan origin must obtain a Return Visa from their jurisdictional FRRO to be eligible to re-enter India after their trip.

Q: When is an Exit Permit required for a person of Tibetan origin?

A: An Exit Permit is required only if the foreigner intends to stay abroad for more than 15 days. This permit is issued by the jurisdictional FRRO.

Q: How does a person of Tibetan origin obtain an Exit Permit?

A: The Exit Permit is issued by the jurisdictional FRRO, but it is

granted based on the recommendation of the Central Tibetan Administration (CTA).

FRRO Locations and Jurisdictions

Q: What is the role of the FRRO in India?

A: The Foreigners Regional Registration Office (FRRO) operates under the Bureau of Immigration (Ministry of Home Affairs). It manages immigration functions and handles all registration and visa-related services for foreign nationals within its specific jurisdiction.

Q: How many FRRO offices are there in India?

A: There are currently fifteen FRRO offices located across the country, each responsible for different States and Union Territories.

FRRO Jurisdictions in India

1. FRRO Ahmedabad: Gujarat and the Union Territories of Daman and Diu and Dadra and Nagar Haveli.
2. FRRO Amritsar: Punjab and the Union Territory of Jammu & Kashmir.
3. FRRO Bangalore: Karnataka.
4. FRRO Calicut: Specific districts in Northern Kerala, including Kannur, Kasaragod, Kozhikode, Malappuram, and Wayanad.
5. FRRO Chandigarh: Union Territory of Chandigarh and the state of Haryana.
6. FRRO Chennai: Tamil Nadu, the Union Territory of Puducherry, and the Andaman & Nicobar Islands.
7. FRRO Cochin: Central districts of Kerala (Alappuzha, Ernakulam, Idukki, Kottayam, Palakkad, and Thrissur) as well as the Union Territory of Lakshadweep.
8. FRRO Delhi: Delhi, Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand. Gautam Buddha Nagar (Noida) and Ghaziabad.
9. FRRO Guwahati: Assam.
10. FRRO Hyderabad: Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, and Odisha.

11. FRRO Jaipur: Rajasthan.
12. FRRO Kolkata: West Bengal, Arunachal Pradesh, Bihar, Jharkhand, Manipur, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Nagaland, Sikkim, and Tripura.
13. FRRO Lucknow: Uttar Pradesh, with the exception of Gautam Buddha Nagar and Ghaziabad (which are under FRRO Delhi).
14. FRRO Mumbai: Maharashtra, Goa, Chhattisgarh, and Madhya Pradesh.
15. FRRO Trivandrum: The southern districts of Kerala, specifically Kollam, Pathanamthitta, and Thiruvananthapuram.

FOREIGNER REGISTRATION REQUIREMENTS (FRRO/FRO)

1: What is the general rule for foreigners regarding registration in India?

A: Foreign nationals must register with the Foreigner's Regional Registration Office (FRRO) or the Foreigner's Registration Office (FRO) based on their visa category, stay duration, and specific endorsements on their visa.

Q: Who are required to register within 14 days of arrival?

A: Foreigners entering India on the following visa types must register within 14 days if their visa is valid for more than 180 days:

- Student Visa
- Employment Visa
- Medical Visa
- Missionary Visa

Q: When does a Business Visa holder need to register?

A: A Business Visa holder is required to register if:

- Their continuous stay in India exceeds 180 days.

- Their aggregate (total) stay within a single calendar year (January to December) exceeds 180 days.

Q: Are there registration requirements for other visa types?

A: Yes. Foreigners on any visa type (excluding those on Official or Diplomatic passports) must register if their continuous stay on a single entry or their aggregate stay in a calendar year exceeds 180 days.

Q: What are the specific registration rules for Pakistani nationals?

A: Pakistani nationals face stricter timelines and must register with the local FRO within 24 hours of their arrival in India.

Q: Which categories of people are exempt from registration?

A: The following groups do not need to register with the FRRO/FRO:

- Children: Anyone below 12 years of age.
- OCI Cardholders: Overseas Citizens of India are fully exempt.
- Neighbouring Citizens: Citizens of Nepal and Bhutan do not require a visa or registration.

Q: What happens if a foreigner fails to register?

A: Non-compliance with registration rules is a serious matter and shall result in legal consequences, which may include fines, restrictions on future travel, or deportation.

Q: Are there any other rules a foreigner should follow?

A: Yes. All foreigners must strictly adhere to any specific conditions or stipulations endorsed on their visa at all times.

SPECIAL CATEGORY REGISTRATION (Pakistan, Afghanistan, Bangladesh)

Q: What are the specific registration rules for Pakistani nationals?

A: Generally, every Pakistani national entering India must register with the local authorities within 24 hours of arrival.

Q: Are there any exceptions to the 24-hour rule for Pakistani nationals?

A: Yes, there are two main exceptions:

- Police Reporting Exemption: Registration is not required if the visa has an official endorsement stating "Exemption from police reporting."
- Medical Visas: Pakistani nationals arriving on a Medical Visa are given a longer window and must register within 7 days of arrival.

Q: How should an Afghan national apply for a stay visa or residential permit?

A: Afghan nationals who wish to apply for a Stay Visa or Residential Permit must do so online via the official portal: indianfrro.gov.in.

Q: When is registration mandatory for Bangladeshi nationals?

A: A Bangladeshi national must register with the jurisdictional FRRO/FRO and obtain a residential permit within 14 days of arrival if they intend to stay in India for a continuous period exceeding six months.

Q: What is a Long Term Visa (LTV), and who is eligible?

A: Certain categories of nationals from Afghanistan, Bangladesh, and Pakistan living in India may be eligible for a Long Term Visa (LTV). This provides extended residency benefits for eligible individuals.

Q: Where can I find the official guidelines for Long Term Visas (LTV)?

A: Detailed instructions regarding the grant and extension of LTV facilities can be found in the Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) documentation here: [MHA LTV Guidelines](#).

VISA EXTENSION AND CONVERSION

Q: What should a foreigner do if they cannot leave India before their visa expires?

A: If a foreigner has justifiable reasons for being unable to exit India within their visa validity, they must apply for the appropriate visa

service (such as an extension) online via the official portal: indianfrro.gov.in.

Q: Can a foreigner apply for a visa extension if they are currently outside of India?

A: No. Visa extension and conversion services are strictly available only to foreign nationals who are physically present in India at the time of application.

Q: When is the best time for a foreigner to apply for a visa service?

A: The application must be submitted within the validity of the current visa. It is highly recommended to apply well in advance to allow reasonable time for the FRRO/FRO to process the request.

Q: What happens if a visa extension or conversion is not granted before the current visa expires?

A: If the permission to extend the stay is not granted within the validity of the current visa, the foreigner must depart from India immediately.

Q: What are the consequences if a foreigner remains in India after their visa expires without an approved extension?

A: Failure to depart will be classified as a wilful illegal overstay. In such cases, the foreigner will be treated in accordance with Indian law, which can include fines, legal action, and restrictions on future entry.

Q: Can a foreigner change their visa type (conversion) while in India?

A: Yes, foreigners can apply for a visa conversion through the same e-FRRO portal if they meet the specific eligibility criteria for the new visa category. However, the same rules apply: the application must be justified and submitted while the current visa is still valid.

EXIT PERMITS, LOST PASSPORTS, AND ADOPTIONS

Q: What should a foreigner do immediately after losing their passport in India?

A: If a foreigner loses their travel document, they must take the following steps promptly:

1. Report the loss to the nearest police station.
2. Inform the jurisdictional FRRO/FRO.
3. Contact their respective Embassy or Mission in India to apply for a new travel document or emergency certificate.

Q: How does a foreigner get a visa after obtaining a replacement passport?

A: Once the foreigner has the new travel document, they must apply for the necessary visa service (such as a visa transfer or extension) online via the official portal: indianfrro.gov.in.

Q: When is an Exit Permit required for international adoptions under CARA guidelines?

A: Exit permits are mandatory for foreign nationals adopting an Indian child. The requirements depend on the child's nationality:

- Child retains Indian nationality: Both adoptive parents must obtain exit permits to travel out of India.
- Child acquires a foreign nationality: Both adoptive parents and the adopted child must obtain exit permits to travel out of India.

Q: Do OCI cardholders need an Exit Permit for adoption cases?

A: Yes. Even if the adoptive parents are OCI cardholders, they must still comply with the exit permit requirements mentioned above for the adoption process.

Q: Can foreign nationals commission surrogacy in India?

A: No. Foreign nationals are strictly not permitted to commission surrogacy in India. The only exception to this rule is for OCI cardholders.

Q: What is the procedure for a foreigner who has overstayed their visa?

A: Any foreigner who has overstayed their visa validity or violated any visa conditions is prohibited from departing India without an Exit

Permit. They must apply for this permit through the jurisdictional FRRO and may be subject to legal penalties or fines.

Q: How a Police Foreign National staying in India, or who has previously stayed in India apply for Clearance Certificate?

A: A Foreign National staying in India, or who has previously stayed in India and wishes to apply for a Police Clearance Certificate (PCC) can do so by applying on www.indianfrro.gov.in/frro.

Q: How Foreign nationals who are abroad and seeking an Indian Police Clearance Certificate (PCC) apply for it?

A: Foreign nationals who are abroad and seeking an Indian PCC, may approach the Indian Mission/ Post in their respective country for obtaining a PCC.

NEWBORN REGISTRATION: Q&A for Foreigners in India

Q: What is the first thing foreign parents should do after their child is born in India?

A: If one or both parents are foreigners, they must notify the Jurisdictional Registration Officer (FRRO) about the birth. This notification must be sent electronically via email within 30 days of the birth.

Q: Why is it necessary to report the birth to the FRRO?

A: Reporting the birth is a prerequisite for accessing essential visa services for the child. This includes:

- Granting a new visa for the newborn.
- Obtaining exit permission when the family is ready to travel abroad.

Q: Does the hospital have a responsibility to report the birth?

A: Yes. Every hospital, nursing home, or medical institution is legally required to furnish information about a child born to foreign parents. They must send this information electronically (via email) to the FRRO within 7 days of the birth.

Q: Are foreign nationals allowed to commission surrogacy in India?

A: Generally, no. Foreign nationals are strictly prohibited from commissioning surrogacy in India.

Note: The only exception to this rule is for OCI (Overseas Citizen of India) cardholders, who are permitted under specific guidelines.

REPORTING THE DEATH OF A FOREIGN NATIONAL

Q: Is it mandatory to report the death of a foreigner in India?

A: Yes. It is mandatory to report the death of any foreign national to the jurisdictional FRRO (Foreigners Regional Registration Office) or FRO.

Q: Do hospitals have a responsibility to report the death?

A: Yes. Every hospital, nursing home, or medical institution must report the death of a foreigner occurring on their premises within seven days. This notification must be sent electronically via email to the jurisdictional FRRO/FRO.

TRANSPORTING MORTAL REMAINS ABROAD

Q: What is required to transport a deceased foreigner back to their native country?

A: A relative or authorized representative must apply for a No Objection Certificate (NOC) from the jurisdictional FRRO/FRO.

Q: What documents are needed for an NOC for international transportation?

A: You will need to provide:

- Official Certificates: Death Certificate (Municipality/Panchayat) and a Death Report from the local Police Station.
- Travel Documents: Copy of the deceased's Passport and Visa, plus the Passport/Visa of the carrier and a copy of the flight ticket.
- Medical Records: Death summary from the Hospital and an Embalming Certificate from an authorized institution.
- Authorization: A request letter from the family to the FRRO and a formal letter from the relevant Embassy or Consulate.

Q: Can a foreign national be cremated or buried in India?

A: Yes, but an NOC for Cremation/Burial must be obtained from the jurisdictional FRRO/FRO first.

Q: What documents are required for local cremation or burial?

A: The requirements include:

- Official Records: Death Certificate, Police Death Report, and Hospital Death Summary.
- Deceased's Info: Copy of the passport and visa.
- Permission/Proofs: NOC from the Church, Mosque, or Crematorium; Indian Address Proof; and a Marriage Certificate (if the deceased was married to an Indian citizen).
- Family Requests: A letter from the family to the FRRO, a request letter from the relative along with their passport copy, and a letter from the Embassy or Consulate.

Q: What should a foreign national do in case of Change of Passport?

A: In case a registered Foreign National renews his/ her passport while staying in India, he/ she shall apply for "Change of Passport" service within 14 days to the jurisdictional FRRO/ FRO at <https://indianfrro.gov.in>.

Q: What should a foreigner do in case of Change of Address?

A: In case of change of residential address, a Foreign National who is registered with the concerned FRRO/ FRO shall submit an application for change of address at <https://indianfrro.gov.in>.

In case the new address comes under the jurisdiction of different FRRO/FRO, he/she shall apply for 'Transfer RC/RP' service on the link above.

Q: What should a foreign national on student visa do in case of change of Academic Course?

A: In case a foreign national on student visa needs a change in the course being undertaken by him/ her, he/ she should obtain a 'Change

of Course' service from the jurisdictional FRRO/ FRO on <https://indianfrro.gov.in> within 14 days of changing the course.

MEDICAL TREATMENT & VISA RULES

Q: Can a foreigner receive medical treatment on a primary visa (like a Tourist or Business visa)?

A: Yes. Any foreigner, including Pakistani nationals, suffering from a minor medical condition that only requires OPD (Outpatient Department) consultation, can receive treatment at any hospital using their existing primary visa.

Q: What happens if a Pakistani national requires hospitalization?

A: If a Pakistani national needs to avail of indoor medical treatment (admission to a hospital), they are required to convert their primary visa into a Medical Visa.

Q: When must other foreign nationals (non-Pakistani) convert to a Medical Visa?

A: A foreigner should apply to convert their primary visa to a Medical Visa in either of the following two scenarios:

1. Extended Stay: The medical treatment is expected to exceed the stay duration allowed by the primary visa.
2. Organ Transplant: The treatment for the disease specifically requires an organ transplant.

Q: How does a foreigner apply for this visa conversion?

A: The application should be submitted through the official e-FRRO portal (indianfrro.gov.in). All visa conversions are subject to the specific terms and conditions laid down by the Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA). It is best to apply as soon as the medical necessity is identified to avoid overstaying the original visa.

ACQUIRING FOREIGN NATIONALITY

Q: Does India allow dual citizenship?

A: No. India does not recognize the concept of dual nationality. The moment an Indian national acquires foreign citizenship, they immediately cease to be an Indian national.

Q: Can a former Indian national continue to use their Indian passport after getting a foreign one?

A: There is a strict 3-month grace period starting from the day of acquisition of the new nationality (e.g., the date on the Naturalization Certificate). Once that grace period expires, holding, acquiring, or traveling on an Indian passport constitutes an offense under the Indian Passport Act, 1967, and attracts severe penalties.

Q: What must a person do if they acquire foreign citizenship while they are staying in India?

A: If an individual acquires foreign nationality while residing in India, they must take the following steps:

- Obtain the passport of their new nationality.
- Surrender their Indian passport, Indian Voter ID, Indian Ration card, and all other relevant Indian nationality documents.
- Apply for appropriate visa services on the e-FRRO portal (<https://indianfrro.gov.in>) within 30 days of acquiring the foreign nationality.

Q: What happens if a person acquires foreign citizenship abroad but enters India using their Indian passport?

A: If an individual enters India on an Indian passport after having already acquired foreign citizenship, they must immediately do the following:

- Surrender their Indian passport, Indian Voter ID, Indian Ration card, and all other related Indian nationality documents.
- Apply for visa services on the e-FRRO portal (<https://indianfrro.gov.in>) within 30 days of their arrival in India.

UNHCR Card Holders & Refugee Status in India

Q: Does India follow the 1951 United Nations Convention regarding refugees?

A: No. It is important to note that India is not a signatory to the 1951 United Nations Convention on the Status of Refugees or the 1967 Protocol. Consequently, refugee status in India is managed through internal administrative policies rather than international treaty obligations.

Q: Can a foreigner with a UNHCR card apply for a visa or residency in India?

A: Yes. Foreign nationals who hold a UNHCR card (for Refugees or Stateless persons) are eligible to apply for appropriate visa services to regularize their stay.

Q: Where should a UNHCR card holder apply for these services?

A: Applications must be submitted electronically through the official e-FRRO portal at indianfrro.gov.in.

Q: Who decides whether the visa will be granted to a UNHCR card holder?

A: Each application is evaluated on a case-by-case basis by the jurisdictional FRRO (Foreigners Regional Registration Office). They will assess the documentation provided and determine the eligibility for the specific visa service requested.

GENERAL REQUIREMENTS FOR FORM III

Q: What is Form III and who needs to fill it?

A: Form III is a mandatory report that every "keeper of accommodation" must submit when a foreign national (including OCI cardholders) stays at their premises. This includes hotels, homestays, hospitals, and even religious institutions.

Q: Does this rule apply to OCI cardholders?

A: Yes. Even though OCI cardholders have many privileges, they are specifically included in the requirement to provide particulars for Form III upon arrival and departure.

Q: In what language should the records be maintained in accommodation?

A: Records should ideally be in English if the host is able to understand. If not, an Indian language is acceptable. If the guest doesn't understand the requirements, it is the host's duty to explain the rules to them.

Q: How long must these records be kept in accommodation?

A: The keeper of the accommodation must maintain electronic records of these particulars for at least one year. These must be available for inspection at any time by a Registration Officer, District Magistrate, or a Police Officer (Head Constable rank or above).

Q: What is the deadline for submitting the arrival report by keeper of the accommodation?

A: The arrival details must be transmitted electronically through the official portal or mobile app within 24 hours of the foreigner's arrival.

Q: Does the keeper of the accommodation need to report when the guest leaves?

A: Yes. Departure details, including the date, time, and the address to which the guest is proceeding, must also be submitted within 24 hours of their departure.

Q: I run a small homestay; do I really need to do form III entry?

A: Yes. The definition of "accommodation" is very broad. It includes:

- Hotels, hostels, boarding houses, and sarais.
- Private rentals, homestays, and paying guest (PG) houses.
- Clubs, dak-bungalows, rest houses, and tents.
- Hospitals and nursing homes.

- Premises of religious or charitable trusts and public organizations.

Q: What are the specific duties of a hospital regarding foreign patients?

A: Hospitals and nursing homes must follow the same 24-hour reporting rules for arrival and departure. However, they have an additional "7-day rule" for life events:

- Births: If a child is born to foreign parents (one or both), the hospital must report it electronically within 7 days.
- Deaths: The death of any foreign national must also be reported electronically within 7 days.

Q: Where can I register and find a guide for Form III?

A: You can register and submit forms at the official e-FRRO portal:

- **Registration Link:** <https://indianfrro.gov.in/frro/FormC>
- **Official Guide:** You can find the "How to register Form-III" PDF directly on the portal for a step-by-step walkthrough.

PENALTIES AND LEGAL CONSEQUENCES

Q: What actions constitute a violation under the Immigration and Foreigners Act, 2025?

A: Legal or penal action may be taken against a foreigner for the following violations:

- Overstaying beyond the visa validity or stay stipulation.
- Non-registration with the FRRO/FRO when required.
- Engaging in unauthorized activities that do not match the specific visa category granted (e.g., working on a tourist visa).
- Non-filing of requisite forms (such as Form III for accommodations).
- Any other contravention of provisions or orders made under the Act.

Q: What are the financial and legal penalties for these offenses?

A: Violations of the Act carry significant consequences. Depending on the nature of the offense, penalties include:

- Fines: Ranging from ₹10,000 to ₹3,00,000 for each individual offense.
- Imprisonment: Serious violations may result in jail time as prescribed under the various sections of the Act.

Q: Are Indian citizens or businesses also liable for a foreigner's visa violations?

A: Yes. The Act holds Indian stakeholders accountable if they are associated with the foreigner. This includes:

- Carriers (Airlines/Transport companies).
- Hoteliers and accommodation providers.
- Educational Institutions.
- Hospitals and medical facilities. If these entities are found violating any provisions (such as failing to report a foreigner's stay or medical treatment), they are equally liable for fines and legal action.

Q: How does a visa violation affect a foreigner's future travel to India?

A: Beyond immediate fines or jail time, violating Indian visa norms is highly likely to result in a blacklisting or a negative record. This will adversely affect the foreigner's chances of obtaining an Indian visa or being granted entry into the country in the future.

FRRO CONTACT DIRECTORY

1. Ahmedabad

- In-Charge: Smt. Sweta Shrimali, IPS
- Address: 235, Ground Floor, HUDCO Bhawan, Iswar Bhuvan Road, Navrangpura, Ahmedabad, Gujarat
- Phone: 079-26306606, 079-26306607 (Fax)

- Email: frroamd@nic.in; afrro-boi.ahd@nic.in (Enquiries)

2. Amritsar

- In-Charge: Sh. Manjeet Singh
- Address: 208, Near Govind Park, Basant Avenue, Amritsar, Punjab
- Phone: 0183-2560464 (T), 0183-2500465 (Fax)
- Email: frroasr@nic.in

3. Bangalore

- In-Charge: Sh. Santosh Babu K, IPS
- Address: 5th Floor, A Block, TTMC, BMTC Bus Stand Building, K.H. Road, Shantinagar, Bangalore - 560027
- Phone: 080-22218195, 080-22218183, 080-22218110, 080-22218196 (Fax)
- Email: frroblr-ka@nic.in; ad-frroblr@mha.gov.in (OCI/PIO Enquiries)

4. Calicut

- In-Charge: Sh. Krishnaraj, IPS
- Address: 6th floor, Nikarthil Chambers, Opposite Sarvaram Bio Park, Mini Bypass Road, Arayidathupalam, Kozhikode, Kerala - 673004
- Phone: 0495-2323550, 0495-2320650
- Email: frro-clt@nic.in; frrocal@nic.in

5. Chandigarh

- In-Charge: Dr. Deepak Siwach, IPS
- Address: First Floor, BSNL Telephone Exchange, Sector 37 D, Chandigarh - 160036
- Phone: 0172-2991498, 0172-2993217, 0172-2991495
- Email: frrochd.support@mha.gov.in

6. Chennai

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- Address: Shastri Bhawan Annexe, Building No. 26 Haddows Road, Nungabakkam, Chennai - 600006
- Phone: 044-28251721, 044-23454971 (Fax), 044-29510706 (OCI queries)
- Email: chiochn@nic.in; frrochn@nic.in

7. Cochin

- In-Charge: Sh. Krishnaraj, IPS
- Address: 2nd Floor, Airlines Offices Building, Cochin International Airport Ltd., Airport PO, Cochin - 683111
- Phone: 0484-2611654, 0484-2611652 (Fax/Support)
- Email: frrococ@nic.in; frrococ-helpdesk@mha.gov.in; oci.frrococ@gov.in (OCI Desk)

8. Delhi

- In-Charge: Sh. Deepak Yadav, IPS
- Address: Level-2, East Block-VIII, Sector-1, R.K Puram, New Delhi - 110066
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- Email: frrodli@nic.in; frrodli.support@nic.in

9. Guwahati

- In-Charge: Sh. Inom Saikia
- Address: LGBI Airport, Borjhar, Guwahati - 781015
- Phone: 0361-2841466
- Email: chioghy-asm@nic.in

10. Hyderabad

- In-Charge: Sh. Venkata Appala Naidu Chintan, IPS

- Address: Sardar Vallabhai Patel BoI OCR Complex, Shamshabad-Pahadishareef Road near GMR Township, Mamidipally, Shamshabad, Telangana - 501218
- Phone: 040-29880374, 040-29880375
- Email: frrohyd@nic.in

11. Jaipur

- In-Charge: Sh. Ramesh Yadav, IPS
- Address: Plot No 01, Jhalana Doongri, Opposite Aranya Bhawan, Jaipur - 302004
- Phone: 0141-2950422, 0141-2950423
- Email: frro.jaipur@gov.in

12. Kolkata

- In-Charge: Ms. Nidhi Rani, IPS
- Address: 237, A.J.C Bose Road, Kolkata
- Phone: 033-22900549 (T)
- Email: frrokol@nic.in

13. Lucknow

- In-Charge: Shri. Harsh Singh, IPS
- Address: FRRO, 12th Floor Hall, No. 1, Kendriya Bhawan, Sec-H Aliganj, Lucknow
- Phone: 0522-2432431 (T), 0522-2432430 (Fax), 0522-2987897 (Visa Services)
- Email: frrolko@nic.in

14. Mumbai

- In-Charge: Ms. Niyati Thaker Dave, IPS
- Address: Annex-II Bldg., 3rd Floor, Badruddin Tayyabji Marg, Behind St. Xavier's College, C.S.T, Mumbai - 400001 (beside Times of India building)

- Phone: 022-22621169 (T), 022-22620721 (Fax), 022-22620446 (Visa Services), 022-22621167 (PIO/OCI)
- Email: frfromum@nic.in

15. Trivandrum

- In-Charge: Sh. Aravind Menon, IPS
- Address: T.C. 30/1398-3, First Floor, Amrith Plaza, Nalumukku, P.O. Pettah, Thiruvananthapuram - 695022
- Phone: 0471-2573512 (T), 0471-2573514 (Fax)
- Email: frrotvm@nic.in

FAQ (Frequently Asked Questions)

1.What is an ETA?

Ans: ETA is an Electronic Travel Authorization. It allows the bearer access into the issuing country (India). ETA is NOT eVisa. When the bearer of ETA is allowed entry into India by the Immigration Officer, it becomes eVisa. eVisa will be stamped on the Passport of the foreigner at the designated ICPs on production of valid ETA.

3. What is the difference between “ETA Expiry date” and “Visa Expiry Date”?

Ans: ETA expiry date is the last date allowing bearer access into India. Visa Expiry Date is the last date permitted for the stay of foreigner in India subjected to any stay stipulation applicable.

3. What activities can I undertake on my Visa?

Ans: You are required to strictly adhere to the purpose of visit declared while submitting the visa application. Kindly refer to terms and conditions of your Visa.

4. Do I need to register with FRRO (Foreigners Regional Registration Officer) after arriving in India?

Ans: Ans: [Click here](https://boi.gov.in/boi/contents/registration-authority/registration-of-foreign-nationals/registration-requirements) for more details.
<https://boi.gov.in/boi/contents/registration-authority/registration-of-foreign-nationals/registration-requirements>

5. What is the difference between “Visa validity/Visa expiry date” and “Stay stipulation”?

Ans: Visa validity or Visa expiry date refers to the validity period during which the foreigner can stay in India on the strength of Visa subject to stay stipulations.

Stay stipulations are the rules which determine the number of days a foreigner may be permitted to stay in India on the strength of Visa. Stay stipulations are of two kinds 1) Continuous stay in India from the date of last arrival. 2) Total Aggregate stay in India during the calendar year.

6. What is the maximum stay allowed on Tourist Visa?

Ans: Maximum stay by a foreigner in India on an e-Tourist Visa or paper Tourist Visa or both in one calendar year shall be restricted to 180 days.

7. What is a calendar year?

Ans: Calendar year refers to period from 1st January to 31st December of the current year.

8. What is “total aggregate stay in a calendar year” and “continuous stay”?

Ans: Total Aggregate stay refers to total period of stay of foreigner in India including multiple visits during the calendar year.

Continuous stay refers to period of stay of foreigner in India since his last arrival.

9. What is maximum duration of stay in Transit if I am not leaving the airport premises?

Ans: Foreigner may be permitted to stay in the designated area of the Airport for the purpose of travelling via connecting flight from India for a period of 24 hours. Transit Visa should be obtained if the waiting period is longer.

10. In case I reach the Arrival Immigration Counter few hours after the expiry of my ETA due to flight delays etc., will I be allowed entry into India on the ETA?

Ans: It may be considered on case to case basis by the Immigration Authorities.

11. In case I reach the Departure Immigration Counter few hours after the expiry of my Visa, will I be allowed to depart from India on that Visa?

Ans: It may be considered on case to case basis by the Immigration Authorities.

12. Can I undertake Tourism while on visit to India on Business/ Conference/ Medical Visa?

Ans: Foreign nationals who are granted a particular type of visa with reference to the purpose of visit shall be required to strictly adhere to the purpose of visit declared while submitting the visa application. However, a foreign national (other than a Pakistani national) coming to India on any type of visa will be allowed to avail activities permitted under Tourist Visa.

13. What is the procedure to obtain Political Clearance Letter issued by Ministry of External Affairs, as required for e-Conference Visa?

Ans: Kindly contact Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) for details.

14. What is the procedure to be followed if child is born in India to parents of foreign nationality?

Ans: Click here for details child born in India

[click here](#) to contact your jurisdictional FRRO.

Contact Details of Bureau of Immigration Headquarters:

Support Centre, Bureau of Immigration

e-mail ID: support-boi@mha.gov.in (For any queries regarding Immigration, Visa etc)

Helpline Number: 011-24300666

**Working hours: 0930 Hrs. to 1800 Hrs. IST (Indian Time)
(Monday to Friday, except public holidays)**

Forms

1. **Annual Salary Certificate format for Visa services**
2. **Monthly Salary Certificate format for Visa services**
3. **Bonafide Certificate format for Visa services**
4. **Medical Certificate format for registration service**
5. **Medical Certificate format for Visa service**
6. **Mutual Consent format for Visa Service/ Exit Permit of minors**